

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA

FAMILY DIVISION A

CASE NO.: 24-DR-001150

SARAH HANSON,

Petitioner/Mother,

v.

CHRISTOPHER HANSON,

Respondent/Father.

NOTICE OF RELATED CASES AND MOTION TO DISQUALIFY ALL 13TH CIRCUIT COURT
JUDGES

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_____ /

NOTICE OF RELATED CASES AND VERIFIED
MOTION TO DISQUALIFY ALL 13TH CIRCUIT COURT JUDGES

Pursuant to Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.545(d), Respondent Christopher Hanson hereby notifies the Court and all parties of the following related cases, which involve common issues of law and fact, overlapping parties, and interconnected allegations of systemic corruption, judicial bias, attorney misconduct, and violations of constitutionally mandated transparency, all stemming from this underlying family law matter. These cases warrant timely action by the Courts to avoid the continuing and mounting appearance of impropriety and/or even silent coordination and collusion across the bench and within the Judiciary at large.

- 25-CA-010255 (Mandamus Suit, 13th Judicial Circuit, Hillsborough County): This is a mandamus action filed by Respondent/Husband/Petitioner in the underlying suit against the 13th Circuit (amended petition for mandamus attached as Exhibit A), seeking to compel proper handling of judicial misconduct complaints related to bias and evidence

suppression in the instant family law case. It shares factual overlap regarding attorney and judicial misconduct involving multiple actors within the 13th Circuit and requires transfer to a new venue given the direct adversarial relationship between Respondent/Husband/Petitioner in this mandamus action and the 13th Circuit.

- 2D2025-1936 (Venue Appeal, Second District Court of Appeal): This appeal challenges the denial of venue change in the instant family law case (based on stale and now incomplete facts) due to judicial bias in the 13th Circuit. It involves the same core allegations of systemic issues affecting fair adjudication.
- 2D2025-0681 (Certiorari Petition, Second District Court of Appeal): This certiorari petition seeks review of Judge Ayers' actions in the instant family law case, which amounts to "fixing" the case against the undersigned - suppressing financial evidence and enabling child weaponization tactics – all to unlawfully thwart Husband's sole objective in the litigation for over a year and a half. It is interconnected through shared evidence and misconduct claims.
- [New Case No., To Be Assigned] (Mandamus/Declaratory Relief, 2nd Judicial Circuit, Leon County): This recently filed action (petition attached as Exhibit B) against The Florida Bar and its officers seeks access to records and reopening of a Bar complaint against attorney Scott Paul Davis for misconduct in the instant family law case. It addresses Bar failures in investigating ethics violations, communicating with the

complainant, and refusals to comply with constitutional transparency requirements tied to this matter, with potential implications for attorney discipline and case integrity.

**ADDITIONAL EVIDENCE OF 13th CIRCUIT BIAS, MISCONDUCT,
AND CONSTITUTIONAL VIOLATIONS DEMONSTRATING
IMPOSSIBILITY OF A FAIR PROCESS FOR RESPONDENT.**

1. On December 18, 2025, Respondent received three letters from the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit (attached as Exhibits C, D, and E) in response to clarifications sought in email correspondence dated December 2, 2025. While the excessive costs for basic records review are problematic, the more significant concern is the Court's continuing refusal to explain, dispute, or rectify its "Intentionally Deceitful, Obstructive and Bad Faith Production: Flooding with Irrelevant Records to Conceal and Deny Access to Requested Materials" in responding to Respondent's July 2025 request for materials related to the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings.
2. Attached as Exhibit F, the email chain leading up to the December 18, 2025 correspondence demonstrates consistent and pointed criticisms at the Court's bad faith conduct intentionally concealing evidence of Ayers' judicial misconduct.
3. While the Court did address the costs of review for the limited scope on the more recent requests (Exhibits C, D, and E), there was no attempt whatsoever to dispute or respond to the facts supporting the bad faith and intentional concealment of records related to the hearings where Respondent's due process rights were clearly violated in this underlying proceeding.
4. The Court's ongoing refusal to account for such bad faith conduct—conduct that violates constitutionally mandated transparency—appears directly tied to systemic efforts to shield Judge Ayers from accountability for documented misconduct.

5. The willingness of the Thirteenth Circuit to violate constitutional requirements at the very core of the present dispute in this case represents such obvious and extreme systemic bias that continuing under this jurisdiction would be a clear violation of due process for Respondent and his family.
6. The updated estimates (\$512.19 for Sabella-related correspondence, \$973.39 for Felix materials, and \$236.02 for Ayers materials) reflect the Circuit's ongoing obstruction and attempts to avoid constitutional transparency requirements.
7. These charges, largely for reviewing documents for confidential material, are even more concerning when contrasted with the hundreds of pages of unrequested records the Court previously produced in response to the Public Records request for the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearing related materials.
8. The Court produced unrequested correspondence without charging for review, yet now demands exorbitant fees for the same activity when the records are specifically requested.
9. The continuing obstacles—excessive fees, lack of explanation, and active and intentional concealment since a July 2025 request—make clear that Respondent cannot obtain a fair process within the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit.
10. This pattern of bad faith amplifies the appearance of impropriety already documented in this motion and throughout the docket, underscoring the urgent need for reassignment to a neutral circuit to preserve due process and public confidence.

**MOTION TO DISQUALIFY ALL 13TH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT JUDGES AND FOR
REASSIGNMENT TO A NEUTRAL CIRCUIT AND IN THE ALTERNATIVE TO SET
HEARINGS ON DAVIS'S MISCONDUCT/SANCTIONS**

COMES NOW, Respondent Christopher Hanson, pursuant to § 38.10, Florida Statutes;
Florida Rule of General Practice and Judicial Administration 2.330; and Canon 3E(1) of the

Florida Code of Judicial Conduct, and moves to disqualify all judges of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, and requests reassignment to a neutral circuit. As grounds, Respondent states: This motion is timely filed within a reasonable time after additional events confirming institutional bias (Court's refusal to dispute, explain, or rectify its concealment of requested evidence, with document dumping intended to distract from the concealment) constituting grounds for Circuit wide disqualification, as required by Rule 2.330(c).

11. The arguments for disqualification in the public records case (25-CA-010255), as detailed in the attached Motion to Disqualify filed on October 31, 2025 (Exhibit F), are even more pertinent in this family law case (24-DR-001150).
12. In the public records action, the motion highlights institutional conflicts and bias within the 13th Circuit that prevent fair adjudication of transparency issues tied to Judge Ayers' misconduct documented throughout the present docket.
13. These concerns are amplified here, where Ayers directly presided over sensitive family matters involving child custody and financial discovery at the core of the parties' dispute.
14. Despite Judge Ayers' disqualification and multiple opportunities, Judge Felix has done nothing to resolve the core issue relating to Judge Ayers' "fixing the case" against Husband, thru suppressing the financial discovery into marital assets.
15. This refusal to take action on such obvious misconduct from Ayers is consistent with the document dumping with concealment described above providing further certainty of the systemic corruption focused on burying the long history of ethical violations in these proceedings.
16. The 13th Circuit was on notice of the parties' core issue and the impact delays were having on Respondent and his family for what will be 2 years in May. (See Docket #22).

17. There is mounting, unrefuted evidence of very serious and intentional prejudice that undermines due process, confidence in the judiciary, and most problematically the children's best interests (See Article I, Section 9 of the Florida Constitution and Florida Rule of General Practice and Judicial Administration 2.330(e)).
18. The systemic protectionism, shielding insiders like Ayers and Davis, demands reassignment to a neutral circuit to ensure impartiality.
19. Alternatively, if the Court declines disqualification or venue transfer, Respondent requests immediate hearings and findings of fact on sanctions related to Davis's misconduct and the core discovery issue raised before this Court in May of 2024.
20. Mr. Davis's obvious and unrefuted misconduct includes ethical violations under Rules Regulating The Florida Bar 4-3.4(c) (failure to comply with discovery obligations) and 4-8.4(d) (conduct prejudicial to the administration of justice), evidenced by ongoing concealment of financial records central to this case.
21. The systemic protectionism and clubhouse corruption described in Husband's article (linked here: <https://x.com/Truthoverchaos/status/1992245722901577796?s=20>) extends to the Circuit at large and the Florida Bar, necessitating Disqualification and the Petition for Mandamus, Exhibits A and B.
22. This request builds on the petition against The Florida Bar, which seeks reopening and reassessment of the complaint against Davis for his wrongdoing in this matter, alongside Ayers' complicity in suppressing evidence and enabling child weaponization.
23. Petitioner first raised pursuing sanctions in correspondence dated December 5, 2024, over a year ago. Docket #59, 60).

24. After excusing Davis's refusal to attend the January 9, 2025 hearing where his misconduct was at the center of the issues, the Court has continued its complete refusal to make findings of fact on Davis's misconduct now ongoing for more than a year.
25. Hearings are requested on the following: Docket 177 (Motion to Strike Wife's Motions for Guardian Ad Litem, Psychological Evaluation, Vocational Evaluation, and Temporary Relief for Lack of Prosecution/Compliance with Court's Request for Summary of Wife's Testimony): This motion addresses Wife's failure to comply with the Court's April 7, 2025 request for a summary of her testimony, warranting sanctions for non-prosecution and striking her pending motions.
26. Docket 239 (Objection to October 9, 2025 Hearing, Motion for Sanctions, and Request for Findings of Fact): This filing objects to procedural irregularities in the hearing, seeks sanctions against Davis for misconduct including evidence suppression and child weaponization, and requests formal findings of fact to document the pattern of bias and ethical violations.
27. Docket 245 (Verified Emergency Motion for Sanctions Including Striking All of Wife's Objections to Financial Discovery, Awarding Husband Fees and Costs, and Referral of Misconduct): This motion demands transparency measures to protect system integrity amid corruption allegations, and sanctions striking Wife's discovery objections due to Davis's concealment tactics, plus fees, costs, and referrals for investigation. It references prior dockets (#112, 183, 192, 197, 198, 209, 211) evidencing the corruption pattern supporting sanctions.

28. Respondent has a well-grounded fear that he will not receive a fair process due to prejudice stemming from the direct, adversarial relationship against the 13th Circuit and multiple Judges within it, including the current Judge, Judge Felix.
29. The history of the case underscores these objectivity concerns with institutional conflicts, personal relationships, and a pattern of protecting insiders, as evidenced in the attached Motion to Disqualify from Case No. 25-CA-010255 (filed October 31, 2025).
30. This extends circuit-wide, as Chief Judge Sabella and others have ignored complaints, fostering a "clubhouse" culture. See *Livingston v. State*, 441 So. 2d 1083, 1086 (Fla. 1983) (disqualification warranted where fear of bias is objectively reasonable).
31. Reassignment to a neutral circuit (e.g., Pasco County, Petitioner's residence) is necessary to preserve due process and public confidence, as the 13th Circuit's self-regulation cannot ensure impartiality. See § 38.10, Fla. Stat. (authorizing disqualification for prejudice); Canon 3E(1) (requiring disqualification where impartiality might reasonably be questioned).

WHEREFORE, Respondent moves for disqualification of all 13th Circuit judges and reassignment to a neutral circuit. Or in the alternative, scheduling the hearings requested above to correct Judge Ayers attempts at “fixing” the case through her suppression of Husband’s core objective, discovery into marital assets concealed during and after the marriage.

VERIFICATION

I, Christopher Hanson, being first duly sworn, depose and say that I am the Respondent in the above-entitled cause; that I have read the foregoing Motion to Disqualify; that the facts stated therein are true and correct to the best of my knowledge and belief; and that this verification is made under penalty of perjury pursuant to Section 92.525, Florida Statutes.

Executed on this 19th day of December, 2025.

/s/ Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, self-represented

FL Bar #44094

cahanson77@yahoo.com (mailto:cahanson77@yahoo.com)

727-409-5738

Certificate of Service

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Notice of Related Cases and Motion to Disqualify All 13th Circuit Court Judges has been furnished via the Court's efling system on this 19th day of December, 2025.

/s/Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson,

FL bar #44094

cahanson77@yahoo.com (mailto:cahanson77@yahoo.com)

727-409-5738

**IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT IN AND FOR
HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA**

CASE NO.: [25-CA-10255]

DIVISION: [B]

CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually and as attorney for himself and attorney/next friend for his minor children [8 years old] and [6 years old], Plaintiffs

v.

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT,

CLERK OF THE COURT FOR THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT, GINA JUSTICE (AND/OR CURRENT COURT ADMINISTRATOR, CHIEF JUDGE CHRISTOPHER C. SABELLA, JUDGE KELLY AYERS, JUDGE MATTHEW FELIX, MIKE MOORE

**AMENDED VERIFIED PETITION/COMPLAINT FOR WRIT OF MANDAMUS, DECLARATORY
RELIEF, AND ATTORNEY'S FEES**

Plaintiff Christopher Hanson, as attorney and next friend for his minor children [8 years old] and [6 years old], hereby amends his original Verified Petition/Complaint for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees, filed on October 14, 2025 (E-Filed October 15, 2025), pursuant to Florida Rule of Civil Procedure 1.190(a). This amendment is filed as a matter of course, as no responsive pleading has been served. The amendment adds defendants, updates factual allegations to reflect ongoing efforts to cover up attorney and judicial misconduct in the 13th Circuit as of November 12, 2025, (including non-responses to additional Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8), and reiterates the legal bases for relief including on Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420, and arguments for the extension of Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, to judicial records, at least where there is evidence of systemic corruption. This amended petition is brought pursuant to Rule 2.420(l) for expedited review of the denial of access to judicial branch court and administrative records. To the extent any requested records are subject to a prior determination of confidentiality (none of which has been identified to Plaintiff), this petition also seeks review and vacation of such determination as

permitted under Rule 2.420(d) and (e). All allegations from the original petition are incorporated herein unless modified.

I. Introduction and Parties:

1. This is an action to enforce the fundamental constitutional right of access to judicial branch records under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, which declares that "[e]very person shall have the right to inspect or copy any public record made or received in connection with the official business of any public body, officer, or employee of the state, or persons acting on their behalf," expressly including "the legislative, executive, and judicial branches of government." Fla. Const. art. I, § 24(a). This petition invokes the presumption of openness that permeates Florida's constitution and broad jurisprudence on state action, where "public trials and deliberations about court records are presumed open" and any exemptions must be narrowly tailored with the burden on the custodian to justify confidentiality. Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988) (emphasizing that "a strong presumption of public access to the court's records exists" and closure is warranted only *upon specific findings* of necessity, with alternatives considered and restrictions as narrow as possible).
2. Plaintiff seeks a writ of mandamus compelling the production of judicial records unlawfully withheld by the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and its officers. These records, identified in detail below and in relevant correspondence, relate to judicial bias, corruption, and misconduct in the underlying family law case involving attorneys on both sides and the bench itself (24-DR-001150). The intentional lack of transparency has directly impacted the children's welfare with no legitimate state interest served. The only apparent motive for the initial, strategic production of documents and the more recent complete non-responsiveness is to cover for Courthouse (clubhouse) insiders who wish to avoid consequences for their misconduct.
3. As the Florida Supreme Court has held, the Constitution's access provision "was adopted to ensure public access to all records that by law were made or received by the personnel of these [governmental] institutions or by persons acting on behalf of these institutions," underscoring that judicial records are not exempt from this mandate absent a justified exemption. Media Gen. Convergence, Inc. v. Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Jud. Cir., 840 So. 2d 1008, 1013 (Fla. 2003) Here, the presumption in favor of transparency is critically important given 13th Circuit representatives

misconduct in the case and motive to conceal damaging materials for no reason other than to avoid consequences for misconduct. Allegations of systemic misconduct demand scrutiny, and any claimed exemption must be "no broader than necessary to accomplish the stated purpose" with specificity, as required by Article I, Section 24(c). See also Rhea v. Dist. Bd. of Trs. of Santa Fe Coll., 109 So. 3d 851, 857 (Fla. 1st DCA 2013) (public records laws "liberally construed in favor of openness").

4. Plaintiff also seeks declaratory relief and attorney's fees under Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l) and any other basis under the law, including statutory, regulatory, and common law grounds. Although Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, does not directly apply to judicial branch records per Times Publishing Co. v. Ake, 660 So. 2d 691, 698 (Fla. 1995) (holding that "chapter 119 has no application to judicial records" but affirming that Rule 2.420 "provides the public access to judicial records required by article I, section 24 of the Florida Constitution"), access remains independently mandated by the Constitution itself and Rule 2.420, which implement a presumption of openness where exemptions must be narrowly construed. Woodard v. State, 885 So. 2d 444, 446 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004) (reiterating constitutional access to judicial records).
5. In balancing interests here—where high-level judicial misconduct threatens public trust and family welfare—the scales tip decisively toward disclosure, as "the burden of the party seeking closure [is] to prove that closure is necessary," with no reasonable alternative and the least restrictive means employed. Barron, 531 So. 2d at 118. Here, the 13th Circuit has fought transparency at every step, causing great damage to this family and public perception of Florida's judicial system. No prior motion for determination of confidentiality under Rule 2.420(e) or (f) is required for this mandamus action, as the denials are administrative in nature and not based on a court order determining confidentiality.

II. Jurisdiction and Venue

6. This Court has jurisdiction under Article V, §5 of the Florida Constitution, §26.012, Florida Statutes, and Rule 2.420(l)(2) for mandamus review of access denials by judicial branch custodians.
7. Venue (prior to the Court's consideration of the corruption and conflicts involved) is proper in Hillsborough County under §47.011 and Rule 2.420, because the defendants reside here and the cause of action primarily accrued here.

III. Parties

8. Plaintiff Christopher Hanson is a licensed Florida attorney acting on his own behalf and acting as attorney and next friend for his minor children, who are residents of Florida and have a direct interest in the requested judicial records, as they pertain to their welfare in the underlying family law case.
9. Defendant Thirteenth Judicial Circuit Court is the judicial branch entity subject to Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Rule 2.420, responsible for maintaining and disclosing judicial records with custodial duties over the Circuit's Court and Administrative records.
10. Defendant Court Administrator/Clerk of the Court for the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit is the entity responsible for custodial duties over judicial records under Rule 2.420(b)(3).
11. Defendant Gina Justice, former Court Administrator, recently left her employment at the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, and no replacement has been named.
12. Defendant Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella is the Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, a public officer who oversees administrative operations, including records management, and serves as custodian under Rule 2.420(b)(3).
13. Defendant Judge Kelly Ayers is a judge in the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and a public officer with potential custodial responsibilities over relevant communications and records under Rule 2.420(b)(3).
14. Defendant Judge Matthew Felix is a judge in the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and a public officer with potential custodial responsibilities over relevant communications and records under Rule 2.420(b)(3), including those related to emergency filings and recusal in Case No. 24-DR-001150.
15. Defendant Mike Moore is the Public Information Officer for the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, involved in processing public records requests.

IV. Relevant Facts:

16. Plaintiff submitted multiple requests for records including several formal letters (Docket #6, Exhibit A, pp. 3–12) to the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit between July 24, 2025, and September 4, 2025, seeking access to:
 - Judicial disqualification and recusal records and associated documents and communications

- Administrative and all other communications regarding the GAL issue including Judge Ayers' request for a summary and Husband's objection to excusing Attorney Davis from drafting the summary.
- Transcripts and filings referenced in public proceedings
- Email and text communications of Judges Kelly Ayers and Wendy DePaul and their judicial assistants related to this case including those related to scheduling, objections, and disqualification/recusal.
- Visual and audio recordings of specified hearings, primarily the April 4, 2025 hearing, offered by Judge Ayers as part of a lie/threat made on the formal transcript.

17. The Court Administrator's response on August 21, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit B, p. 14), confirmed the existence of records satisfying these requests, acknowledging responsive communications but providing only partial, redacted productions without affidavits confirming complete searches or explanations for omissions. Here, the Court administrator's responses confirm sufficient identification of my legal right to clearly defined information, the Court identified and confirmed its availability (Docket #6, Exhibit B, p. 14). However, in follow-up correspondence on October 9, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit F, p. 20), Plaintiff highlighted the complete absence of any records relating to the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025 hearings in the records produced, despite the Administrator's confirmation of their existence—indicating deliberate withholding.

18. The evidence demonstrates defendants' intent to subvert the truth and conceal evidence of judicial misconduct. (Docket #6, 10, 11). The Court administrator failed to produce the requested records (relating to the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearings prior to and during which, the Court obviously and severely violated plaintiff's due process rights) while providing voluminous records never requested (communications associated with all hearings not referenced in Plaintiff's requests).

19. The Court failed to respond at all to several questions and attempts to investigate the obvious failures to cooperate in good faith with these public records requests. Docket #6, p. 20-24. No court order determining confidentiality of these records has been issued or provided to Plaintiff. This failure contravenes the presumption of transparency, especially amid credible, unrefuted allegations of misconduct at the highest levels of the 13th Circuit. Given the Public Interest in uncovering systemic corruption, any exemption must be narrowly tailored (see Rhea v. Dist. Bd. of

Trustees of Santa Fe Coll., 109 So. 3d 851 (Fla. 1st DCA 2013), stressing that public records laws are to be liberally construed in favor of openness).

20. Plaintiff received responses full of tedious unrequested information while the 13th Circuit sneakily concealed the evidence actually requested and relevant to plaintiff while the Court offered purported justification for withholding the specific video at issue that will show Judge Ayers demonstrating obvious bias in open Court, lying about it, and then offering to get the video in a threatening manner. (Docket #6, 10, 11). Correspondence from Gina Justice, Court Administrator, dated August 21, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit B, pp. 13–15), September 4, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit C, p. 16), and September 8, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit D, p. 17). The Court acknowledged the existence of responsive records, but continued the pattern of clubhouse corruption in concealing the relevant evidence that would expose insider misconduct. There is nothing in the responsive documents from the 13th Circuit that constitutes a formal determination of confidentiality under Rule 2.420(d) or (e). The Court confirmed the existence of relevant evidence while failing to justify deviation from the presumption of openness, particularly given concerns of judicial misconduct that heighten the public interest in transparency (see Barron, 531 So. 2d at 118, requiring overriding public necessity for closure).
21. These responses were inadequate and failed to address key concerns, including the selective omission of materials Plaintiff requested for the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025 hearings. Instead, Ms. Justice produced only voluminous, unrequested records for unrelated proceedings, suggesting an intent to obscure the concealment of evidence of systemic misconduct and corruption in the 13th Circuit. (Docket #6, p. 13-22).
22. The September 8, 2025 letter from Ms. Justice denied access to the April 4, 2025 video recording referencing the confidential nature of Court surveillance video, without ever identifying the April 4 video as coming from the surveillance system. The Court administrator refused to acknowledge Judge Ayers' offering the video on the record, raising concerns about inconsistent treatment, open and obvious bias, and concealment of Public Records to avoid consequences within the Circuit Clubhouse. This denial is administrative and reviewable by mandamus under Rule 2.420(l). The confidentiality referenced lacks the narrow tailoring required for any exemption amid allegations of high-level misconduct in the 13th Circuit (see Media Gen. Convergence, 840 So. 2d at 1013-14, mandating specific findings to overcome the presumption of access).

23. Plaintiff has exhausted all informal remedies and administrative channels, including follow-ups on August 26, August 31, September 9, September 12, September 24, and October 9, 2025 (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24). Defendants never responded to any of the follow-up requests for documents or explanations from September 9, 2025 forward besides an email from Moore acknowledging receipt and ensuring processing in a “reasonable” time. As of November 12, 2025, no further responses or productions have been received, exacerbating the ongoing harm.

24. On October 14, 2025, Plaintiff submitted additional Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8 to Defendants, seeking records directly related to the ongoing misconduct in Case No. 24-DR-001150 (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-12), including:

- Request 6: Handling of correspondence with Chief Judge Sabella's office, including emails/letters from January 22, February 12, March 11, August 13, and August 16, 2025, regarding ethical violations by attorney Scott Davis and Judge Ayers' bias/cover-up (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-3).
- Request 7: Communications involving Judge Felix and his assistants about Plaintiff or the case, including emergency filings (Docket Nos. 246, 245, 233, 232, 230, 210, 209, 181) and post-recusal correspondence (Addendum Composite, pp. 4-5).
- Request 8: Judge Ayers' disqualification records/complaints from January 1, 2020, to present, including those related to GAL issues or the Ayo and Iken law firm (Addendum Composite, pp. 6-7).

25. These requests received only a form acknowledgment email on October 14, 2025, with no substantive response, production, timeline, or explanation for delays (Addendum Composite, pp. 8-12, including follow-ups on October 27, 2025 and November 12, 2025, demanding timely compliance. This total silence contrasts with partial responses to earlier requests, suggesting a more direct approach to the Court's obstruction efforts. In their completely unlawful efforts to avoid consequences for the clubhouse insiders guilty of severe misconduct and directly responsible for serious harm to a Florida family, the Court's current actions demonstrate an intentional strategy to subvert the truth to cover for bad judicial actors even at the expense of the citizens they've sworn to serve. The Court has completely failed to offer any materials sought in the most recent requests (e.g., Sabella's non-responsiveness, Felix's involvement, Ayers' disqualifications), further evidencing bad faith and constructive denial.

26. Ongoing failures include:

- Intentional concealment of records relating to due process violations and bias associated with the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings and the April 4, 2025 video, all with no good faith basis under the Florida Constitution and Rule 2.420.
- No explanation for the Court's concealment and/or lack of any communications regarding the hearings on December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, which raise concerns about irregular proceedings and concealment given the existence of emails surrounding less controversial matters.
- No clarification on how "security" video exists only for the April 4, 2025 hearing (Docket #6, Docket #198), whether the camera recording that footage is part of an actual security system, and why no similar footage exists for other relevant hearings or cases.
- Refusal to provide any information by email, despite repeated requests, leading to inefficiencies such as Plaintiff's September emails and the Court's September 4, 2025 letter crossing in the mail. This reliance on U.S. Mail appears deliberate to delay access and violates the intent of Rule 2.420 for prompt disclosure.
- No written explanations with specific citations for any withholdings even with the detailed questions posed.
- No response to requests for affidavits describing search methods, including which devices were searched (e.g., personal devices) to confirm completeness.

27. Defendants' complete non-response to these specific concerns and requests, combined with the partial responses (raising significant concerns about strategic withholding/concealment of specific materials of relevance), provides further evidence of bias, bad faith, and systemic corruption. There is an undeniable pattern where 13th Circuit "Clubhouse" members are circling the wagons to protect fellow insiders, in violation of public access rights under Rule 2.420. Such actions undermine the presumption of transparency, especially when misconduct at the highest levels is at stake, requiring strict scrutiny and narrow tailoring of any restrictions (see *Rhea*, 109 So. 3d at 857).

28. This obstruction has caused ongoing harm to Plaintiff and his family. The October 9, 2025 email (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24) explicitly stated: "The ongoing and intentional concealment of evidence critical to my case... is causing ongoing and increasing damage to my children and my health. I do not believe there's any good faith basis to conceal the evidence identified nor even offer any clarification

regarding the video evidence. I have real concerns about the veracity of some of the representations and the court's failure to even confirm devices searched."

29. Defendants' failure to respond since their September 8, 2025 letter aside from the form response, demonstrates active concealment and bad faith, particularly in light of the pre-suit notice and the problem with misconduct, corruption, and dishonesty in the underlying case.
30. The Thirteenth Judicial Circuit is acting in bad faith, as evidenced by the deliberate pattern of delays, non-responses, and strategically incomplete disclosures that seem to protect Judge Ayers, attorney Scott Davis, and other insiders by concealing extensive evidence that would cause the Court and the bar embarrassment and likely more significant discipline. This pattern heightens the need for transparency to expose misconduct at the highest levels, as the presumption favors disclosure unless narrowly justified (see Barron, 531 So. 2d at 119).
31. The singular issue in the underlying case (24-DR-001150) is Husband's discovery efforts given Wife's concealment of marital assets at the time the parties entered a post-marital agreement without counsel. Attorney Scott Davis, representing Wife, proceeded with a legal strategy to delay, harass, burden, and obstruct Husband's access to obviously discoverable and critically relevant financial discovery, in direct violation of the Florida Bar Rules.
32. Judge Ayers actively assisted Wife and her attorney's obstruction strategies, suppressed evidence of obvious ethical misconduct from multiple attorneys, all to Husband's detriment, and actively sought to advance Wife's clearly retaliatory litigation (e.g., Docket #6, Exhibit G, pp. 25–83, detailing procedural irregularities, suppression of discovery, and failure to address ethical violations; Docket #6, Exhibit H, pp. 84–170, correspondence to Chief Judge Sabella).
33. Plaintiff sought assistance from the Chief Judge on numerous occasions as he consistently ignored the gross misconduct occurring in the Court he's sworn to oversee. (Docket #6, p. 84-170).
34. With respect to requested Court communications on the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings (Docket #6, p. 3-4, 7-8), Ms. Gina Justice, as Court administrator, intentionally concealed relevant evidence of judicial misconduct while actively burdening Plaintiff with irrelevant and unrequested documents. (Docket #6, 10, 11).
35. The Court Administrator not only failed to comply with the Court's duties under Rule 2.420 and the Florida constitution, the evidence demonstrates intentional deceit

with the Court's voluminous response consisting of unrequested records with the relevant ones requested conspicuously absent. (Docket #6, 10, 11).

36. These actions underscore the need for unhindered public access to records to ensure accountability and strict compliance with the Court's duty to narrowly tailor any Court and administrative records withheld from production, aligning with the constitutional presumption of openness (see Media Gen. Convergence, 840 So. 2d at 1014).
37. The Judicial system has clearly allowed ethical compliance to falter to a point where the events described herein are a reality causing active harm to citizens.
38. A "Fox guarding the hen house" style of oversight dominated proceedings to date in the 13th Circuit and the Public Records request process.
39. The Florida and Federal Constitutions demand transparency to restore public trust in the institution.

V. Legal Basis for Relief

40. Under Article I, §24 of the Florida Constitution, every person has a right to inspect or copy any public record made or received in connection with the official business of any public body, officer, or employee of the state, or persons acting on their behalf, except with respect to records exempted pursuant to this section or specifically made confidential by the Constitution. This includes judicial branch records, with a strong presumption in favor of access (see Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113 (Fla. 1988); see also Woodard v. State, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004)).
41. Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420 implements this constitutional right for judicial branch records, establishing procedures for access, exemptions, and review of denials through mandamus or other appropriate relief (Rule 2.420(l)). The rule presumes openness, and exemptions must be narrowly construed. The requested records are "court records" or "administrative records" under Rule 2.420(b)(1) and are not exempt under Rule 2.420(c) unless properly determined confidential, which has not occurred here. Given allegations of misconduct at the highest levels of the 13th Circuit, any claimed exemption must be justified with specificity and narrowly tailored to override the presumption (see Rhea v. Dist. Bd. of Trustees of Santa Fe Coll., 109 So. 3d 851 (Fla. 1st DCA 2013)).
42. While Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, did not apply to judicial branch records under Times Publishing Co. v. Ake, 660 So. 2d 691 (Fla. 1995), Plaintiff submits that the

level of corruption that's festered in the 13th Circuit under these facts require reassessing applicability of Chapter 119 to the Judiciary. Ake should be distinguished or reconsidered here, as the requested records (e.g., communications and videos) are administrative in nature and essential to combating corruption. Nonetheless, relief is independently available under the Federal and Florida Constitutions and Rule 2.420.

43. Defendants' failure to produce records and respond to questions about obvious failure and concealment efforts violates Rule 2.420 and entitles Plaintiff to mandamus relief under Rule 2.420(l) and attorney fees and costs under relevant common law. The Defendants' asserted exemptions are invalid, intentionally misleading, and/or overly broad under Rule 2.420(c), as no specific basis was provided that fits the facts and documents at issue, and no court order determining confidentiality exists under Rule 2.420(d) or (e). (Town of Manalapan v. Rechler, 674 So. 2d 789 (Fla. 4th DCA 1996), finding unreasonable delay or non-response constitutes bad faith warranting fees).
44. The presumption of transparency is particularly vital here to address concerns of judicial misconduct, requiring any withholding to be narrowly tailored (see Media Gen. Convergence, Inc. v. Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, 840 So. 2d 1008 (Fla. 2003)). The non-responses to Requests 6-8 exemplify this pattern, violating the presumption of openness and shifting the burden to Defendants to justify exemptions (Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113 (Fla. 1988)).
45. The intentional concealment and non-responses to specific inquiries (e.g., devices searched, explanations for lack of footage/communications) demonstrate unreasonable and intentional delay, bad faith, and a pattern of inserting inefficiency in an attempt to advance concealment efforts.
46. The September 8, 2025 response's exemption claim for the April 4, 2025 video is a last-ditch attempt to justify continuing concealment of evidence the Judge offered to provide, when she attempted to use the offer as a threat that might help restore her credibility. (Docket #6, Exhibit E, pp. 18–19) This claim does not meet the requirements for a confidentiality determination under Rule 2.420(d)(1)(B) or (e), failing the narrow tailoring requirement amid high-level misconduct concerns (see Barron, 531 So. 2d at 118).
47. It was immediately after Husband insisted on the record that Ayers follow through with her threat to produce the video when the concealment efforts started, and have now continued ever since. (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24). There are now

multiple layers of misconduct stemming largely from Defendants' efforts to assist Mr. Davis in his misconduct to conceal financial evidence and marital assets. Plaintiff is constitutionally entitled to the very transparency that has the change to restore justice for the Citizens of Hillsborough County.

48. Additionally and alternatively, Defendants' failure to respond to the October 9, 2025 email, which asserted "ongoing and intentional concealment" and fee entitlement, further evidences active bad faith. (Docket #6, Exhibit F, pp. 20–24)
49. Plaintiff is entitled to declaratory relief for himself and on behalf of his minor children under Chapter 86, Florida Statutes, to order production of the materials, clarify the legal duties of the Defendants under Rule 2.420, and/or otherwise mandate compliance.
50. Plaintiff is entitled to attorney's fees under Rule 2.420, Chapter 86, and Common Law for Defendants' bad faith and unreasonable obstruction to accessing Public Records, including enhanced awards for bad faith based on the pattern of delays, obstruction, non-responses to follow-ups, and evidence of bias/concealment. Alternatively, fees are available under §119.12 if Chapter 119 applies, or under common law/equity for bad faith conduct (see *Wood v. Marston*, 442 So. 2d 934 (Fla. 1983)).
51. Mandamus is appropriate where a petitioner demonstrates (1) a clear legal right to the requested relief, (2) an indisputable legal duty on the part of the respondent to perform the act, and (3) the absence of any other adequate remedy at law. See *Huffman v. State*, 813 So. 2d 10, 11 (Fla. 2000). Plaintiff satisfies each element here largely based on admissions from the 13th Circuit Court administrator who responded to the first 5 requests, acknowledging the right, duty, and existence of responsive records. (Docket #6, pp. 13-17).
52. Plaintiff has a clear legal right to access judicial records under Article I, § 24 of the Florida Constitution and Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420, which establish a strong presumption of openness. Second, Defendants, as custodians of judicial and administrative records, have an indisputable legal duty to produce those records unless a valid, narrowly tailored exemption is established. No such exemption or confidentiality finding exists despite the Circuit's obvious efforts toward concealment of its systemic corruption. Plaintiff lacks any adequate alternative remedy, having exhausted informal and administrative channels without response, leaving mandamus as the only mechanism to compel compliance with critical constitutional and statutory duties.

VI. Certification/Declaration:

53. I, Christopher Hanson, declare under penalty of perjury that the following is true and correct to the best of my knowledge:

- I am acting as attorney and next friend for my minor children, whose interests are directly affected by the withheld records in the underlying litigation wrought with corruption, harmful delays and intentional obstruction subverting Truth and Justice, all actively supported by the 13th Circuit Defendants.
- I submitted the public records requests attached as Docket #6, Exhibit A (pp. 3–12).
- I received the responses attached as Docket #6, Exhibit B (pp. 13–15), Exhibit C (p. 16), and Exhibit D (p. 17), and the September 15, 2025 acknowledgment email.
- I reference the transcript excerpts attached as Docket #6, Exhibit E (pp. 18–19), which document the Court’s acknowledgment of video footage and refusal to retrieve it.
- I submitted timely follow-up correspondence, including that included within the October 9, 2025 email chain to Mike Moore, attached as Docket #6, Exhibit F (pp. 20–24).
- I filed the motion to supplement the appellate record attached as Docket #6, Exhibit G (pp. 25–83) due to the video’s critical evidence to the underlying case, which documents bias through procedural irregularities (e.g., pp. 25–26, 32–33 on video offer and non-production; pp. 27–31 on ethical violations ignored).
- Some of the records sought pertain to judicial scheduling, recusal, and procedural communications in Case No. 24-DR-001150.
- The responses from the Court Administrator confirm the existence of responsive records without qualifying the public records sought under any exemptions.
- I have experienced retaliatory conduct following lawful public records requests, including unaddressed questions that independently raise further concerns over bias, corruption and ongoing cover-up attempts during plaintiff’s year and a half under the Court’s jurisdiction.
- The Court administrator (Docket #6, Exhibits B-D) failed to address follow-ups on August 26, August 31, September 9, September 12, September 24, and October 9, 2025. Specifically, Defendants concealed relevant evidence, pursued a strategy of burying Plaintiff in irrelevant, unrequested documents, and refused to offer explanations for lack of communications produced for requested hearings, December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025. The Defendants also specifically failed to qualify the April 4, 2025 hearing video under any exemption and refused Plaintiff’s requests for clarification on "security" video

existence only for April 4, 2025, whether the camera is part of a security system, and why no footage exists for other hearing dates if it's truly "security" footage.

- Judicial officers have obstructed access to records and failed to comply with access rights under Rule 2.420, as evidenced by the pattern of ignored ethical concerns detailed in Docket #6, Exhibits G and H (pp. 84–170). This non-response pattern further confirms the bias, concealment, and "13th Circuit Clubhouse" culture where all the "members" have circled their wagons to protect insiders, violating public access rights.
- I submitted additional Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8 on October 14, 2025 (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-12), and follow-ups, with no substantive response as of November 12, 2025, further evidencing bad faith.
- The exhibits provide solid unrefuted evidence supporting the 13th Circuit's failures, refusals, and intentional actions in violation of Plaintiff's due process rights.

Certified and executed on November 13, 2025.

/s/Christopher Hanson
 Christopher Hanson
 cahanson77@yahoo.com
 727-409-5738

VII. Prayer for Relief

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully requests that this Court:

A. Issue a writ of mandamus under Rule 2.420(l) compelling Defendants to produce the following records immediately and without hearing, as time is of the essence:

- all emails and text messages and/or any other form of written communication, sent or received by Judge Kelly Ayers, her judicial assistant, (Dwauna Heyward), and/or any other 13th Circuit representative who participated in scheduling the 12-13-24 hearing on Case No. 24-DR-1150, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanso. Specifically, I'm requesting all of these materials from December 1, 2024, to December 20, 2024, including communications with court staff, attorneys and/or their agents, or others about scheduling and/or attendance at the hearing on December 13, 2024 (per Records request, pp. 3-4),
- all emails and text messages and/or any other form of written communication, sent or received by Judge Kelly Ayers, her judicial assistant (Dwauna Heyward), and/or any other 13th Circuit representative who participated in scheduling the January 9, 2025 hearing on Case No. 24-DR-11550, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah

Hanson and Christopher Hanson. Specifically, I am requesting all of these materials from December 21, 2024, to January 20, 2025, including communications with court staff, attorneys and/or their agents, or others about scheduling and/or attendance at the hearing on January 9, 2025.

- All visual and audio recordings of the April 4, 2025 hearing,
- All emails and text messages and/or any other form of written communication sent or received by Judge Wendy J. DePaul, her judicial assistant, and/or any other 13th Circuit representative who participated in or discussed the recusal in and/or all other documentation regarding Judge DePaul's involvement with Case No. 24-DR-001150, In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson. Specifically, all materials from April 1, 2025, to May 31, 2025, including communications with court staff, other judges, attorneys and/or their agents, or others about the recusal, the decision to recuse, or the issuance of the Order of Recusal dated April 28, 2025. This includes, but is not limited to, any internal memos, notes, drafts, or correspondence related to the recusal process.
- All communications regarding the April 7, 2025 request for summary of Wife's testimony and Husband's motion to strike
- All records responsive to Public Records Requests 6, 7, and 8 dated October 14, 2025 (Addendum Composite, pp. 1-12), including handling of Sabella correspondence, Felix communications, and Ayers disqualification records.
- all public records related to the handling of concerns described in the letters and emails I sent to Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella and/or his judicial assistant(s) concerning Case No. 24-DR-001150 (In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson) as further specified at Addendum composite (recently filed), p. 1-3.
- all public records of communications involving Judge Felix (and/or his judicial assistant(s)) about Christopher Hanson and/or Case No. 24-DR-001150 (In Re: The Marriage of Sarah Hanson and Christopher Hanson) in the Family Law Division as further specified at Addendum composite (recently filed), p. 4-5.
- all public records related to Judge Kelly Ayers' involvement in any and all disqualification scenarios, complaints, or concerns about her impartiality, honesty, and professionalism as further specified at Addendum composite (recently filed), p. 6-7.

B. Due to the bad faith and efforts in support of concealment exhibited thus far, compel Defendants to provide affidavits describing search targets, methods, including which devices were searched (e.g., personal devices), to confirm completeness of production, what applications, emails, text programs searched to confirm compliance, and if applicable, justification for failing to search personal devices including text messages of Judge Ayers, her assistant, and other individuals involved in the events described above.

C. Compel Defendants to provide written explanations, with specific evidentiary and rule-based citations, for:

- The lack of any communications regarding the hearings on December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025.
- How "security" video exists only for the April 4, 2025 hearing.
- Whether the camera recording footage on April 4, 2025, is part of an actual security system.
- Why no footage exists for other relevant hearings or cases.
- Specification on withholdings or exemptions claimed in the partial responses.
- The delays and inconsistent handling of Requests 6-8 compared to earlier requests.

D. Declare that Defendants violated Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and Rule 2.420 through unlawful refusal, non-response to clarifications and follow-ups, refusal, and patterns of delay evidencing bias and concealment; to the extent any confidentiality determination exists, declare it invalid and vacate it under Rule 2.420(d) and (e);

E. Award attorney's fees and costs under Rule 2.420(l), §119.12 (alternative), §86.111, and common law/equity for bad faith, including enhancements;

F. Grant such other relief as the Court deems just and proper.

Respectfully submitted,

/s/Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, as attorney and next friend for his minor children

727-409-5738

cahanson77@yahoo.com

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Amended Verified Petition/Complaint for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees was filed through the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal and service attempted via the Portal's e-service system on November 13, 2025, (with additional email service directly from Plaintiff) to the following recipients: Clerk of Court for the 13th Judicial Circuit at publicinfo@fljud13.org and rowlanda@fljud13.org, Gina Justice, Court Administrator at gina.justice@fljud13.org, and TCA@fljud13.org, Mike Moore, Public Information Officer, mike.moore@fljud13.org, Judge Kelly Ayers at famlawdivd@fljud13.org, Judge Matthew Felix at famlawdiva@fljud13.org, Judge Christopher Sabella at cornelcm@fljud13.org,

/s/ Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, Esq.

Florida Bar No. 44094

cahanson77@yahoo.com

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE SECOND JUDICIAL CIRCUIT IN
AND FOR LEON COUNTY, FLORIDA

CASE NO.: [To Be Assigned]

(IN RE) CHRISTOPHER HANSON, individually and as attorney for himself and attorney/next friend for his minor children \[8 years old] and \[6 years old],

Petitioner,

v.

THE FLORIDA BAR, RICHARD COURTEMANCHE, ALLIE HUSTON, and ALICIA GANGI

Respondents.

VERIFIED PETITION/COMPLAINT FOR WRIT OF
MANDAMUS, DECLARATORY RELIEF, AND ATTORNEY'S FEES AND COSTS

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Respondents.

VERIFIED PETITION/COMPLAINT FOR WRIT OF
MANDAMUS, DECLARATORY RELIEF, AND ATTORNEY'S FEES AND COSTS

Petitioner Christopher Hanson, as attorney for himself and next friend and attorney for his minor children, files this Verified Petition for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees and Costs against The Florida Bar and its named officers/representatives, pursuant to Article V, Section 5(b) of the Florida Constitution, compelling Respondents to comply with their clear legal duties under the Florida Constitution and the Rules Regulating The Florida Bar, including but not limited to Rules 3-7.1 and 3-7.3, by providing engagement, transparency and access to public records related to Bar Complaint No. W015656-111025 against attorney Scott Paul Davis (RFA No. 25-6861), which among other relief requested, should be reopened for a proper investigation and discipline to deter further misconduct in the cases discussed herein, and for all future litigants in Florida.

1. Petitioner requests relief under Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l) for expedited review of the denial of access to judicial branch records, declaratory intervention, and relief under common law, the constitution and in equity.

2. To the extent any requested records are subject to a prior determination of confidentiality (none of which has been identified to Petitioner), this petition also seeks review and vacation of such determination as permitted under Rule 2.420(d) and (e).
3. Petitioner also seeks mandamus and/or declaratory relief relating to failures in handling the unrefuted violations described in the Davis complaint (Appendix, Item 5, pp. 40-64), conflicts of interest within the Florida Bar relating to additional disciplinary matters concerning Petitioner, Judge Ayers, and additional members and representatives of the Florida Bar.

I. Jurisdiction

4. This Court has original jurisdiction to issue writs of mandamus directing The Florida Bar and the other defendants in the performance of its regulatory functions, as the Bar operates under the Court's authority. See Art. V, § 5(b), Fla. Const. (empowering circuit courts to issue writs of mandamus); Art. V, § 15, Fla. Const., R. Regulating Fla. Bar 1-12.1.; see also The Fla. Bar v. Committee, 916 So. 2d 741 (Fla. 2005) (confirming the judiciary's supervisory authority over Bar disciplinary records and processes under Rule 3-7.1).
5. This Court also has jurisdiction over declaratory relief pursuant to Chapter 86, Florida Statutes, which empowers circuit courts to declare rights, status, and other equitable or legal relations, including in cases involving constitutional rights and administrative actions. See §86.011, Fla. Stat.
6. Additionally, this Court possesses inherent equitable jurisdiction to grant relief in equity, including injunctions and other remedies to prevent irreparable harm from ongoing

violations of constitutional and regulatory duties. See Art. V, § 5(b), Fla. Const. (granting circuit courts broad equity powers).

7. Venue is proper in Leon County as the principal place of business for The Florida Bar and the location where the cause of action accrued. See §47.011, Fla. Stat.; The Fla. Bar v. Ray, 797 So. 2d 556 (Fla. 2001) (actions against the Bar typically venued in Leon County).

II. Introduction and Parties

8. This is an action to enforce the fundamental constitutional right of access to judicial branch records under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, which declares that "[e]very person shall have the right to inspect or copy any public record made or received in connection with the official business of any public body, officer, or employee of the state, or persons acting on their behalf," expressly including "the legislative, executive, and judicial branches of government." Fla. Const. art. I, § 24(a).
9. This petition invokes the presumption of openness that permeates Florida's constitution and broad jurisprudence on state action, where "public trials and deliberations about court records are presumed open" and any exemptions must be narrowly tailored with the burden on the custodian to justify confidentiality. Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988).
10. Petitioner Christopher Hanson is a resident of Hillsborough County, Florida, and a member of The Florida Bar.
11. He is the complainant in the underlying Bar matter and has standing as the requester of public records under Article I, Section 24, Florida Constitution, and Rule 2.420, as the complainant in the bar complaint against Davis, and as the Respondent in Ayers' complaint

against him, with certain rights including “engagement” with the Bar in the investigation process.

12. As next friend for his minor children, he asserts their interests in records impacting their welfare in the family law case.
13. Respondent The Florida Bar is the custodian of the records at issue, operating as an arm of the judicial branch under Article V, Section 15, Florida Constitution.
14. Respondents Richard Courtemanche, Allie Huston, and Alicia Gangi are Bar officers or representatives involved in the handling, investigation, and/or denial of access to the requested records and information.
15. Petitioner seeks a writ of mandamus compelling the production of records unlawfully withheld by The Florida Bar and its officers, answers to basic questions that went unanswered due to the bar’s failing to “engage” with petitioner (in violation of their own rules), and corrective actions for failures in accountability and damage to public confidence in the judiciary these facts have produced to date.
16. These requests, identified in detail below and in relevant correspondence, relate to attorney misconduct and the Bar’s handling of a complaint against Scott Paul Davis (Florida Bar No. 0074284, RFA No. 25-6861). Appendix Items 1 and 2, p. 1-36).

III. Factual Background

A. Davis’s Misconduct and Concealment of Financial Evidence

17. The facts surrounding the bar complaint against Davis demonstrate Judicial bias and systemic corruption dominating the underlying family law case (24-DR-001150) and the

JQC's handling of Petitioner's complaint on Judge Ayers. (Appendix Items 5, 15, and 16, pp. 40-64, 185-201, 202-205).

18. The ministerial duties the Florida Bar shirked, necessitating this petition/complaint, relate to Davis's and Ayers' misconduct in concealing/suppressing clearly discoverable financial evidence at the core of the parties' dispute as Petitioner explained in his initial filing back in May of 2024.

19. The concealment and suppression of discoverable financial records violated Fla. R. Civ. P. 1.280(b) and ethical obligations under Rule 4-3.4(c) to obey discovery rules. See Appendix Item 17, pp. 244–275 (Writ for Certiorari detailing Judge Ayers' suppression of financial evidence central to equitable distribution); Appendix Item 18, pp. 276–281 (See also Item 19, pp. 282-285, Initial pleading emphasizing urgency of financial discovery).

B. Instead of Addressing Davis's Ethical Violations, Ayers Actively Assists with Suppression.

20. Judge Ayers "fixed" the underlying family law case (24-DR-001150) by repeatedly excusing Davis's misconduct while suppressing efforts to obtain financial discovery, the only reason for any litigation between the parties.

21. These actions contravened Canon 3B(7) of the Florida Code of Judicial Conduct, requiring judges to accord full right to be heard and dispose promptly of proceedings. See Appendix Item 16, pp. 202–243 (Initial brief challenging venue denial and systemic bias).

22. This suppression enabled Davis's tactics of child weaponization—using the children as leverage through unfounded allegations and prolonged litigation—causing ongoing emotional harm to the minor children and delaying resolution for over a year. See Canon 3B(7), Fla. Code Jud. Conduct and Appendix Item 17, pp. 244–275.

23. The initial misconduct involving Davis and then Ayers' refusal to address it triggered a massive cover-up that now encompasses the 13th Judicial Circuit (through withheld records and venue trapping), the Florida Bar (via non-investigation of Davis and advancement of Ayers' retaliatory complaint), and the JQC (via summary dismissal of Petitioner's complaint against Ayers without inquiry).
24. This systemic protectionism prioritizes insiders over public accountability, perpetuating the harm to Petitioner's family and eroding judicial integrity. Williams-Yulee v. Fla. Bar, 575 U.S. 433, 445 (2015) (emphasizing impartiality in disciplinary processes to avoid due process violations); See Appendix Items 16–19, pp. 202–285 (collective evidence of systemic failures, retaliatory complaints, and concealment of core records). Appendix Item 15, pp. 185-201 (JQC complaint against Ayers illustrating interconnected conflicts and lack of transparency); Appendix Item 10, pp. 97-119 (Ayers' retaliatory Bar complaint as evidence of abuse of process).

C. The Florida Bar Violates its Own Rules in Protecting Davis (and Ayers) from Accountability for their Misconduct:

25. The Florida Bar's intentional lack of transparency and refusal to engage, even in direct violation of Rules 3-7.1 and 3-7.3, have directly harmed petitioner and his family with no legitimate state interest served.
26. The only apparent motive for the refusal to engage and continuing concealment of materials exchanged with Davis from the partial production of documents (on November 10, 2025) is to cover for insiders who wish to avoid consequences for their misconduct.

27. The unrefuted and irrefutable nature of Davis's misconduct make it impossible for anyone to actually excuse or justify his (Ayers's and others') actions, so silence and concealment are the only ways to accomplish their unwavering goal to protect insiders.
28. As the Florida Supreme Court has held, the Constitution's access provision "was adopted to ensure public access to all records that by law were made or received by the personnel of these institutions or by persons acting on behalf of these institutions," underscoring that judicial records are not exempt from this mandate absent a justified exemption. Media Gen. Convergence, Inc. v. Chief Judge of the Thirteenth Jud. Cir., 840 So. 2d 1008, 1013 (Fla. 2003).
29. Here, as in any case where evidence points to broad systemic corruption and insider protectionism at the expense of litigants and the public in general, the presumption in favor of transparency is critically important given the Bar's role in regulating the legal profession and citizens' access to justice. Id.
30. In a "lawyers policing lawyers" system like The Florida Bar's self-regulatory framework, transparency is a constitutional mandate, a safeguard against inherent conflicts and potential corruption.
31. The public interest demands heightened access to records where, as here, there are allegations of broad systemic corruption and insider protectionism, enabling unchecked judicial and attorney misconduct. See The Fla. Bar v. Davis, 661 So. 2d 1193, 1197 (Fla. 1995) (noting that public confidence in judicial integrity erodes when corruption is perceived, emphasizing the need for transparency to maintain trust).

32. On February 18, 2025, Petitioner filed a detailed complaint with The Florida Bar against Attorney Scott Paul Davis (Florida Bar No. 0074284) for still unrefuted ethical violations in family law case 24-DR-001150, including delays, harassment, concealment, and child weaponization tactics. (Appendix Item 5, pp. 40-64.)
33. Despite repeated good-faith efforts to engage—documented in a 25-page email chain spanning February to November 2025—the Bar provided form acknowledgments to a fraction of his efforts and no meaningful investigation, interview, nor interest in the additional evidence and clarification offered. (Appendix Item 2, pp. 12-36.)
34. The complaint was improperly dismissed without probable cause, exonerating Davis despite substantiated allegations. (Appendix Item 6, p. 65.) To date, Davis has never disputed any of the specific facts alleged in the complaint despite many opportunities in pleadings, correspondence, and in open Court.
35. Petitioner sought closed file reviews and appeals, but the Bar's opacity and refusals to engage persisted. (Appendix Items 3-4, pp. 37-39.)

D. The Florida Bar Continues to Protect Insiders from Accountability as it Refuses to Comply with Constitutionally Mandated Transparency:

36. On November 10, 2025, in response to public records request W015656-111025, the Bar provided incomplete records, omitting substantive communications with Davis except a typographical error email. (Appendix Item 2, pp. 12-36.)
37. Petitioner's December 1, 2025, follow-up narrowed the inquiry to four specific questions about Davis communications, privilege claims, and a confidentiality index, but received no response. (Appendix Item 1, pp. 1-11.)

38. Petitioner's detailed follow up from December 15, 2025 received only further disinterest, stating, "This matter is closed."

39. This non-responsiveness mirrors the Bar's pattern since February 2025, including failures under Rule 3-7.3(c) (preliminary investigation) and Rule 3-7.1(b) (public records - concealment of rebuttal materials and correspondence with Davis).

40. The Bar's handling contrasts sharply with its advancement of a vague, retaliatory complaint against Petitioner by Judge Kelly Ayers (File No. 2026-10,395(13F)), requiring Petitioner's formal response while potentially excusing Davis entirely. (Appendix Items 9-12, pp. 96-127.)

41. The withheld records are essential to ensuring accountability for misconduct, restoring fairness in the family law case, and rehabilitating confidence in the judiciary.

E. The Florida Bar fails to meet its Burden in Justifying the Refusals to Engage and Comply with Constitutional Transparency

42. The Bar has never offered any explanation nor any rebuttal materials for its decision to dismiss the bar complaint beyond the absurd idea that it was deferring the disciplinary issues to co-conspirator (also guilty of severe misconduct), Ayers.

43. No exemptions apply in that the Florida Bar has still not even disclosed whether rebuttal materials exist nor what correspondence with Davis was ever sent or received.

44. Per The Florida Bar, "the matter is closed" making the records public under Rule 3-7.1(b), which expressly defines "public record" to include "any reports, correspondence, papers, and other materials furnished to, served on, or received from the respondent." See R.

Regulating Fla. Bar 3-7.1(b) (emphasizing that closed cases without probable cause become public records); see also The Fla. Bar v. Committe, 916 So. 2d 741, 745 (Fla. 2005) (interpreting Rule 3-7.1 to require public access absent valid confidentiality exemptions).

45. Specifically, the Florida Bar continues to conceal records, correspondence, and other materials sent to or received from Attorney Davis fall squarely within this definition, while refusing to answer basic questions. (Appendix Items 1, 16, pp. 1-11, 202-205).

46. The Bar refuses even to confirm whether a response or rebuttal materials were ever submitted by Davis, a position that defies the plain language of Rule 3-7.1 and undermines the constitutional presumption of openness articulated in Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988).

47. The burden is on the custodian to justify its refusal to engage with Petitioner on the Bar Complaint and any claimed exemptions from .

48. These refusals to engage, answer the simple questions and/or provide a privilege log are directly contrary to Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution.

49. Such secrecy erodes public confidence and makes judicial intervention imperative.

IV. Conflicts of Interest and Systemic Corruption

50. The Bar's conduct underscores systemic conflicts of interest.

51. Its refusal to investigate substantiated and unrefuted allegations against Attorney Scott Paul Davis parallels the retaliatory complaint advanced by Judge Kelly Ayers against Petitioner—a complaint filed as File No. 2026-10,395(13F) and advanced by the Bar despite its vague

and unsupported (even unnamed) allegations. (Appendix Items 9-10, pp. 96-119; see also Appendix Item 11, pp. 120-122 (Petitioner's response to retaliatory complaint).)

52. At the same time, the Bar dismissed the Davis complaint without requiring Mr. Davis to offer any alternative explanation for the severe and intentional pattern of ethical violations outlined in Petitioner's Bar complaint. (Appendix Item 6, p. 65)

53. This selective enforcement and use of the Bar to protect insiders and attack those who demand accountability violates due process and expands corruption in the judicial system. See Williams-Yulee v. Fla. Bar, 575 U.S. 433, 445 (2015) (discussing the importance of impartiality in Bar disciplinary processes to avoid due process concerns); see also The Fla. Bar v. Ray, 797 So. 2d 556, 559 (Fla. 2001) (emphasizing fair application of disciplinary rules to maintain public trust).

54. This disparity and the continuing refusals to comply with constitutionally mandated transparency confirms the institutional bias favoring judicial insiders over complainants, warranting mandamus to address the absurdity and restore equity. (See Appendix Item 15, pp. 185-201 (related JQC complaint against Judge Ayers illustrating interconnected conflicts)).

55. The underlying family law misconduct ongoing for more than a year exemplifies the harm to litigants that including judicial bias in case 24-DR-001150, further compounds these issues. (Appendix Items 17, 18, pp. 206-275).

56. Petitioner's motion to disqualify Judge Ayers details patterns of favoritism and non-transparency that the Bar and JQC ignored. (Appendix Item 7, pp. 66-78.)

57. The Bar's non-engagement perpetuates this cycle, as evidenced in ongoing appellate motions challenging systemic failures. (Appendix Item 13, pp. 129-141.)

58. Such conduct not only harms Petitioner's family but undermines the Bar's regulatory integrity.

V. Legal Arguments for Mandamus and Relief

A. Mandamus to Compel Record Production and Reopen the Bar Complaint for Proper Handling Consistent with the Facts and Law described Herein:

59. A petitioner seeking a writ of mandamus must establish three key elements: (1) a clear legal right to the requested relief; (2) that the respondent has an indubitable legal duty to perform the requested action, which must be ministerial rather than discretionary; and (3) the absence of any other adequate legal remedy.

i. Clear legal right:

60. Petitioner has a clear legal right to the requested relief, including full access to public records related to Bar Complaint No. W015656-111025 and the reopening of the investigation into attorney Scott Paul Davis's misconduct, as guaranteed by Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, which mandates public access to judicial branch records, and by Rule 3-7.1 of the Rules Regulating The Florida Bar, which defines such correspondence and reports as part of the public record absent justified exemptions—which none exist here. See *The Fla. Bar v. Committe*, 916 So. 2d 741, 745 (Fla. 2005) (mandamus appropriate to enforce access to Bar records under Rule 3-7.1 where confidentiality not established).

61. The Bar's Failure to Engage and Provide Transparency Under Rule 3-7.1: Rule 3-7.1(b) defines "public record" broadly to include "any reports, correspondence, papers ... furnished to, served on, or received from the respondent."
62. Petitioner has repeatedly requested confirmation of communications with Mr. Davis beyond a minor typo email, yet the Bar refuses to disclose or even index such materials, claiming privilege in direct conflict with Rule 3-7.1(b). (Appendix Items 1-2, pp. 1-36.)
63. This opacity violates the Bar's mandate for constitutional transparency, as Florida's constitution and due process require access to records impacting private rights.
64. The Bar's position—that only a judicial finding of misconduct triggers action—creates an absurd barrier when the judge (Ayers) is implicated, enabling systemic evasion to the great detriment of citizens and their confidence in the judicial system.

ii. Indubitable Legal Duty (Ministerial, Not Discretionary)

65. Respondents, including The Florida Bar and its officers Richard Courtemanche, Allie Huston, and Alicia Gangi, have an indubitable legal duty to perform the requested actions, which are ministerial in nature—such as providing access to non-confidential records under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420 and conducting a proper preliminary investigation under Rule 3-7.3(c)—as these duties involve no discretion but rather mandatory compliance with established rules to ensure transparency and accountability in attorney discipline (see Appendix Item 17, pp. 244-275, detailing unaddressed violations).
66. To rehabilitate confidence in these institutions, the Bar must immediately produce: · All communications with Mr. Davis or his representatives; (Appendix Item 1, pp. 1-11

(unanswered questions on these communications)) or a sworn affidavit confirming none exist;

- A detailed privilege/confidentiality index for any withheld items;
- Confirmation of searches, including personal devices of all Bar employees and representatives who worked on the case; and
- A written explanation of the search process and devices searched to ensure compliance and transparency.
- Sworn statements from defendants described further below.

67. Accordingly, mandamus and/or declaratory relief is necessary to require the Bar to reopen the complaint against Mr. Scott Davis and perform a proper investigation with the engagement required by the rules. See Tyson v. Fla. Bar, 826 So. 2d 265, 267 (Fla. 2002) (entertaining mandamus petition to compel Bar to reopen disciplinary investigation where initial closure was inadequate); see also Fla. Bar v. Thompson, 979 So. 2d 917, 919 (Fla. 2008) (affirming court's authority to review Bar actions via mandamus for failure to fulfill duties).

68. As part of the order, necessary to ensure accountability and protect the public, Petitioner requests the Court appoint an independent counsel and/or tribunal to oversee the investigation into the Davis complaint.

69. The Court's authority to compel reopening of a disciplinary matter arises from its inherent supervisory power over The Florida Bar under Article V, Section 15 of the Florida Constitution.

70. Independent oversight is imperative given the levels of insider protectionism and systemic corruption at the expense of litigants.

iii. No Other Adequate Remedy at Law

71. Petitioner has no other adequate remedy at law, as informal requests for records and engagement have been ignored or denied despite months of documented efforts (as evidenced by the email correspondence in Appendix Items 1-2, pp. 1-36), and administrative appeals within The Florida Bar are unavailable or ineffective given the systemic issues alleged, leaving mandamus as the only means to compel compliance and prevent irreparable harm to public confidence in the judicial system.

72. Without this writ, the Bar's ongoing failures will continue to perpetuate unchecked attorney misconduct, further eroding trust in Florida's legal institutions and causing direct, ongoing harm to Petitioner, his minor children, and other litigants similarly situated, with no alternative forum or process capable of providing timely and complete relief.

B. Declaratory Relief:

73. Petitioner seeks a declaration that Respondents' withholding violates Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, Rule 3-7.1, and Rule 2.420, as the records are public and no valid exemption justifies secrecy.

74. This pattern—advancing a retaliatory complaint from Judge Ayers while dismissing substantiated allegations against Davis—demonstrates selective enforcement and institutional self-preservation.

75. This further justifies declaratory relief including payment of petitioner's attorney's fees and costs to enforce constitutional transparency and deter future misconduct.
76. Florida courts have emphasized that transparency is essential to maintain trust in judicial and quasi-judicial bodies. See *Barron v. Fla. Freedom Newspapers, Inc.*, 531 So. 2d 113, 116 (Fla. 1988) (presumption of openness places burden on custodian to justify confidentiality); *Florida Bar v. Ray*, 797 So. 2d 556 (Fla. 2001) (truth as defense to criticism; supports exposure of misconduct).
77. Given the Bar's refusal to engage with the complainant and its failure to justify dismissal, declaratory relief is necessary to enforce constitutional mandates and deter future misconduct.
78. Petitioner further seeks a declaration that Respondents' advancement of a retaliatory complaint against Petitioner while simultaneously ignoring substantiated allegations against Attorney Scott Paul Davis constitutes an abuse of process and violates Petitioner's due process rights under the Florida and United States Constitutions.
79. Such selective enforcement and systemic bias undermine public confidence in the integrity of the disciplinary system and warrant judicial intervention to prevent further harm and restore fairness. See *Williams-Yulee v. Fla. Bar*, 575 U.S. 433, 446 (2015) (highlighting due process implications in uneven Bar enforcement).

C. Public Interest, Hardship, and Irreparable Harm

80. The obstacles the 13th Circuit and the Florida Bar have created to avoid transparency and having to explain their excusal of such obvious and intentional misconduct would be determinative for most litigants; they would simply never have access to justice. (See

Appendix Item 14, pp. 142-184, referencing the article "Foxes Guarding the Courthouse"
 Link: <https://x.com/Truthoverchaos/status/1992245722901577796?s=20>.)

81. Even more concerning, the obstacles to engagement and transparency would forever bury the misconduct David and Ayers committed in these facts for over a year.
82. Petitioner is in a unique position in that his many years of litigation experience allowed him to notice and document these almost unbelievably obvious and severe violations of the ethical rules for over a year; as pointed out in the article, "Foxes Guarding the Courthouse," this is the perfect storm to bring accountability to those guilty of ethical violations including those at the Florida Bar who violated their own rules, in part of the attempted cover-up. (See Appendix Item 14, pp. 142-184).
83. These obstacles to transparency and refusals to engage cause significant delays and damages during times that are inherently difficult and stressful; perpetuating systemic issues like insider protectionism and avoiding transparency mandates places future litigants, who rely on the Bar to uphold ethical standards under Article V, Section 15 of the Florida Constitution, at increased risk of harm. (See Appendix Items 5, 15, and 16, pp. 40-64, 185-201, 202-205, evidencing unaddressed misconduct in the underlying family law case (24-DR-001150) and related complaints.)
84. The facts of this case are likely not unique, raising concern over how many families Ayers' and Davis's misconduct unfairly impacted in the time prior to and after the events described herein, creating increased urgency for action from this Court. (See Appendix Item 17, pp. 244-275, detailing suppression of evidence central to family welfare.)

85. This hardship is compounded by the Bar's refusal to engage, forcing Petitioner into this petition as a last resort, with no adequate compensation for the time, stress, and family suffering caused by a dispute that should have been resolved over a year ago but for the misconduct and cover-ups described herein.

D. Bad Faith and Willful Non-Compliance:

86. Respondents' actions evidence bad faith, including willful delays, strategic concealment of information/documents, and selective enforcement.

87. The Bar ignored repeated requests for engagement under the rules since February 2025, provided incomplete records, and failed to justify exemptions, suggesting an intent to shield insiders amid corruption allegations.

88. Bad faith warrants mandatory fees under § 119.12(1), Fla. Stat., where unlawful refusal occurs (even analogously for judicial records should the Court refuse expansive consideration of 119.12(1)), as courts award fees to deter such conduct and promote compliance. *New Times, Inc. v. Monroe County Sheriff's Office*, 245 So. 3d 740 (Fla. 3d DCA 2018). See also *Bd. of Trs., Jacksonville Police & Fire Pension Fund v. Lee*, 189 So. 3d 120, 125 (Fla. 2016) (holding that agencies must pay fees for unlawful withholding of public records, even absent bad faith, to encourage compliance).

E. Attorney's Fees and Costs:

89. Petitioner is entitled to attorney's fees and costs under multiple grounds, including Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l) for mandamus relief from denials of access to judicial records; Chapter 86, Florida Statutes, and §86.111 for declaratory relief based on bad faith and unreasonable obstruction; and common law and equity principles for

Respondents' pattern of delays, non-responses, failure/refusal to engage, obstruction, bias, and concealment, warranting enhanced awards as exemplified in *Town of Manalapan v. Rechler*, 674 So. 2d 789 (Fla. 4th DCA 1996) (unreasonable delay or non-response constitutes bad faith) and *Wood v. Marston*, 442 So. 2d 934 (Fla. 1983) (fee awards for bad faith conduct).

90. Alternatively, fees are available under §119.12, Florida Statutes, if Chapter 119 applies, particularly given the systemic corruption in the 13th Circuit necessitating a reassessment or distinction of *Times Publishing Co. v. Ake*, 660 So. 2d 691 (Fla. 1995), where the requested records are administrative in nature and essential to combating corruption; under equitable principles and public interest exceptions to deter future misconduct and prevent burdens on citizens enforcing constitutional guarantees, as affirmed in *Woodard v. State*, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004) (fee entitlement in mandamus actions implicating public interest transparency); and independently under the Federal and Florida Constitutions for violations of Article I, Section 24 and due process rights.

91. Respondents' unlawful withholding of records and aggressive refusal to engage as required by the rules, all in bad faith, evidenced by ongoing delays since February 2025, selective omissions, and complete non-responses to recent inquiries on information that must be in the public record, further supports this entitlement.

92. Courts have recognized that mandamus actions involving transparency justify fee awards to deter future misconduct and ensure citizens are not burdened for enforcing constitutional guarantees. *Woodard v. State*, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004) (affirming fee entitlement in mandamus actions implicating public interest transparency).

See also *Bd. of Trs. v. Lee*, 189 So. 3d at 125 (mandatory fees for unlawful records withholding to promote access). VI. V. Clear Legal Duty and No Adequate Remedy

VI. Conclusion:

93. The Bar has a ministerial duty to engage with the complainant, conduct at least a preliminary investigation, and disclose public records.

94. It's failed in all of those duties as described herein and demonstrated in the appendix materials.

95. Mandamus is appropriate where, as here, administrative remedies are exhausted and no alternative exists. See *Fla. Bar v. Thompson*, 979 So. 2d 917 (Fla. 2008). ; see also *Tyson v. Fla. Bar*, 813 So. 2d at 1022 (mandamus lies to compel Bar's performance of clear duties in disciplinary matters).

96. As Petitioner has made clear throughout this process, time is of the essence and timely orders on these issues are appropriate given the Bar's failure to respond or otherwise engage for several months.

VII. Prayer for Relief

WHEREFORE, in addition to the relief already requested, Petitioner respectfully prays this Court:

1. Declare Respondents' actions relating to the deficiencies described above violative of Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution; Rule 3-7.1; and Rule 2.420

2. Issue a writ of mandamus compelling:

- Immediate production of all requested records including but not limited to all materials sent to and/or received from Mr. Davis and/or anyone on his behalf. Specifically, this includes all communications involving Mr. Davis to or from Alicia Gangi, Allie Huston, and all other bar employees and representatives or a sworn statement confirming none exist;

- A detailed privilege log;

- Searches of personal devices of all Bar employees and representatives involved in the matter;

- A written explanation of the search process and devices searched;

3. Reopen the Davis complaint and conduct a proper investigation required by the Rules.

4. Require Mandatory engagement with Petitioner regarding the Bar's handling of the Davis complaint under Rule 3-7.3(c).

5. Appoint independent counsel or tribunal to oversee the Davis investigation and the initial mishandling of it to ensure impartiality, accountability, and public confidence.

6. Require Ms. Gangi and Ms. Huston to complete sworn statements explaining the failure/refusal to "engage" with Petitioner regarding the Davis bar complaint and describing any conversations with Mr. Davis and anyone else with whom the complaint and related matters were discussed. Order Ms. Gangi and Ms. Huston to appear for depositions should questions remain after review of the sworn statements.

7. Require Mr. Courtemanche to Huston to complete a sworn statements explaining the refusal to comply with bar rules and transparency requirements with an order to appear for deposition should questions remain after review of the sworn statements.

8. Order Judge Ayers to provide a sworn statement advising of any and all statements from Petitioner she believes to be untrue and dismiss the retaliatory Bar complaint against Petitioner (File No. 2026-10,395(13F)) as an abuse of process and violation of due process rights.
9. Refer the Judicial Qualifications Commission's dismissal of Petitioner's complaint against Judge Ayers to the Florida Supreme Court for review and reassessment, given the systemic conflicts and lack of transparency documented herein. (Appendix Item 15, pp. 185-201.)
10. Appoint another independent counsel or tribunal to oversee the investigation and handling of bar complaints (not yet filed due to concerns of bias, insider protectionism and systemic corruption in the FL Bar, but) necessary for other individuals involved in the facts discussed herein. The Bar finding the obvious misconduct in those related cases still to come would further highlight the Bar's failures in the Davis case, so an independent counsel is necessary for objectivity.
11. Find Section 119 applicable to these proceedings involving significant systemic corruption and a quasi-judicial body acting more as a state agency, making Chapter 119's requirements critical for public protection.
12. Award reasonable attorney fees and costs under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420(l) for mandamus relief; Ch. 86, Fla. Stat., and §86.111 for declaratory relief based on bad faith and obstruction; common law/equity for Respondents' delays, non-responses, failure to engage, obstruction, bias, and concealment, warranting enhanced awards per Town of Manalapan v. Rechler, 674 So. 2d 789 (Fla. 4th DCA 1996) and Wood v. Marston, 442 So. 2d 934 (Fla. 1983). Additionally and alternatively under §119.12, Fla. Stat., if Ch. 119 applies, given the agency like functions of the Florida Bar and systemic corruption requiring reassessment of Times Publishing Co. v. Ake, 660

So. 2d 691 (Fla. 1995); under equitable/public interest principles to deter misconduct per Woodard v. State, 885 So. 2d 444 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004); and under the Florida Constitutions for violations of Art. I, § 24 and due process rights.

13. Pursuant to Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420(l), grant expedited review of Respondents' denial of engagement and access to Bar records, within 30 days of this filing, to prevent further irreparable harm from ongoing opacity, delays in family law proceedings, and erosion of public confidence in the judicial system, as detailed in Sections III (Factual Background) and V. C (Public Interest, Hardship, and Irreparable Harm)

14. Grant such other relief as the Court deems just and proper to ensure transparency, deter future misconduct, and restore public confidence.

15. Petitioner specifically requests a jury trial for any and all issues so triable.

Verification:

I, Christopher Hanson, on December 17, 2025, swear under penalty of perjury that the foregoing is true and correct based on my personal knowledge.

/s/ Christopher Alan Hanson
Christopher Alan Hanson

Certificate of Service

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Verified Petition for Writ of Mandamus, Declaratory Relief, and Attorney's Fees has been furnished by email to:

The Florida Bar
Attn: Richard Courtemanche, Allie Huston, Alicia Gangi,
651 East Jefferson Street

Tallahassee, Florida 32399-2300

rcourtemanche@floridabar.org; acapintake@floridabar.org; agangi@gunster.com

on this 17th day of December, 2025.

/s/ Christopher Alan Hanson

Christopher Alan Hanson

FL Bar No. 44094

Cahanson77@yahoo.com

727-409-5738

3934 E Eden Roc Cir

Tampa FL 33634



ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICE OF THE COURTS
THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT OF FLORIDA

December 18, 2025

**ORIGINAL SENT VIA USPS
& SCANNED COPY SENT VIA EMAIL**

Mr. Christopher Hanson
3934 E. Eden Roc Circle
Tampa, Florida 33634-7418
Cahanson77@yahoo.com

Dear Mr. Hanson:

Your correspondence sent to Christina Novia on October 14, 2025, regarding your *"Public Records Request – Handling of Correspondence with Chief Judge Christopher C. Sabella's Office Regarding Case No. 24-DR-001150"* was forwarded on to me for response.

As you have been advised in previous correspondence, Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, does not apply to records of the judicial branch of government. *Times v. Ake*, 660 So. 2d 255 (Fla. 1995) (the judicial branch of government is not an "agency" subject to Chapter 119, Florida Statutes). Therefore, we are treating your public records request as a request for administrative records of the judicial branch in accordance with Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420 and article I, section 24 of the Florida Constitution.

According to Rule 2.420(m)(3), fees for copies of judicial records are the same as provided in section 119.07, Florida Statutes. Section 119.07(4)(a)1 authorizes the assessment of 15 cents per page and section 119.07(4)(d) authorizes the assessment of a special service charge if the nature or volume of public records is such as to require extensive use of information technology resources or extensive clerical or supervisory assistance.

The nature and volume of the records your broad request seeks will require extensive clerical or supervisory assistance. As such, prior to furnishing any of the judicial records that you have requested, we will need to receive an advance deposit of the special services charge.

In calculating an estimate of the special services charge to fulfill this specific request regarding records related to the handling of correspondence with Chief Judge Sabella, 1,122 emails have been identified that may be responsive to your broad public records request. The total estimated special services charge of \$512.19, as documented below, does not include

Mr. Christopher Hanson
December 18, 2025
Page 2

shipping charges or the 15-cent per page duplication cost. We cannot estimate the shipping and duplication charges until we determine how many non-confidential records are responsive to your request.

FUNCTION	TIME	RATE	COST
Paralegal to review 1,122 emails for confidential information and, if applicable, redact confidential information from those records	Estimated time: 9.35 hours (30 seconds per e-mail = $1,122 \times 30 = 33,660$ seconds $\div$ 60 seconds = 561 minutes $\div$ 60 minutes = 9.35 hours)	\$40.04 per hour (\$29.66 base pay plus 35% benefits)	\$374.37
Staff counsel to review paralegal's work	Estimated time = 1.5 hours	\$91.88 per hour (\$68.06 base pay plus 35% benefits)	\$137.82
TOTAL ESTIMATED SPECIAL SERVICES CHARGE			\$512.19

Please be advised that in order to begin the work of reviewing the identified records for confidential information, we must first receive a deposit of \$512.20. You may submit a check for this amount made payable to "BOCC" to my assistant: Janice Albury, Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, George Edgecomb Courthouse, 800 East Twiggs Street, Room 604, Tampa FL 33602.

After the records are reviewed and confidential information is redacted from these records, a final invoice will be prepared and provided to you indicating the special services charge actually incurred, the shipping charges, and the duplication costs. If the amount due on the final invoice is more than your deposit, then you will be required to pay the difference prior to delivery of the records. If the amount due on the final invoice is less than your deposit, we will start a refund process when we send you the non-confidential records.

Sincerely,



Richard T. Melendi
Chief Deputy Court Administrator - Operations

cc: K. Angela Smith, Interim Court Administrator



ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICE OF THE COURTS
THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT OF FLORIDA

December 17, 2025

**ORIGINAL SENT VIA USPS
& SCANNED COPY SENT VIA EMAIL**

Mr. Christopher Hanson
3934 E. Eden Roc Circle
Tampa, Florida 33634-7418
Cahanson77@yahoo.com

Dear Mr. Hanson:

This letter is response to our email exchange of December 3, 2025, regarding your "Narrowed *scope of Public Records Request for Ayers and Felix materials and Request for immediate compliance.*"

As you have been advised in previous correspondence, Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, does not apply to records of the judicial branch of government. *Times v. Ake*, 660 So. 2d 255 (Fla. 1995) (the judicial branch of government is not an "agency" subject to Chapter 119, Florida Statutes). Therefore, we are treating your public records email request as an amended request for administrative records of the judicial branch in accordance with Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420 and article I, section 24 of the Florida Constitution.

According to Rule 2.420(m)(3), fees for copies of judicial records are the same as provided in section 119.07, Florida Statutes. Section 119.07(4)(a)1 authorizes the assessment of 15 cents per page and section 119.07(4)(d) authorizes the assessment of a special service charge if the nature or volume of public records is such as to require extensive use of information technology resources or extensive clerical or supervisory assistance.

The nature and volume of the records your amended request seeks will require extensive clerical or supervisory assistance. As such, prior to furnishing any of the judicial records that you have requested, we will need to receive an advance deposit of the special services charge.

In calculating an estimate of the special services charge to fulfill the amended request regarding Judge Felix's records, 2,154 emails have been identified that may be responsive to your amended public records request. The total estimated special services charge of \$973.39, as documented below, does not include shipping charges or the 15-cent per page duplication

Mr. Christopher Hanson
 December 17, 2025
 Page 2

cost. We cannot estimate the shipping and duplication charges until we determine how many non-confidential records are responsive to your request.

FUNCTION	TIME	RATE	COST
Paralegal to review 2,164 emails for confidential information and, if applicable, redact confidential information from those records	Estimated time: 18.0 hours (30 seconds per e-mail = $2,164 \times 30 = 64,920$ seconds + 60 seconds = 1,082 minutes + 60 minutes = 18.0 hours)	\$40.04 per hour ($\29.66 base pay plus 35% benefits)	\$720.72
Staff counsel to review paralegal's work	Estimated time = 2.75 hour	\$91.88 per hour ($\68.06 base pay plus 35% benefits)	\$252.67
TOTAL ESTIMATED SPECIAL SERVICES CHARGE			\$973.39

Please be advised that in order to begin the work of reviewing the identified records for confidential information, we must first receive a deposit of \$973.39. You may submit a check for this amount made payable to "BOCC" to my assistant: Janice Albury, Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, George Edgecomb Courthouse, 800 East Twiggs Street, Room 604, Tampa FL 33602.

After the records are reviewed and confidential information is redacted from these records, a final invoice will be prepared and provided to you indicating the special services charge actually incurred, the shipping charges, and the duplication costs. If the amount due on the final invoice is more than your deposit, then you will be required to pay the difference prior to delivery of the records. If the amount due on the final invoice is less than your deposit, we will start a refund process when we send you the non-confidential records.

Sincerely,



Richard T. Melendi
 Chief Deputy Court Administrator - Operations

cc: K. Angela Smith, Interim Court Administrator



ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICE OF THE COURTS
THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT OF FLORIDA

December 17, 2025

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Mr. Christopher Hanson
3934 E. Eden Roc Circle
Tampa, Florida 33634-7418
Cahanson77@yahoo.com

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According to Rule 2.420(m)(3), fees for copies of judicial records are the same as provided in section 119.07, Florida Statutes. Section 119.07(4)(a)1 authorizes the assessment of 15 cents per page and section 119.07(4)(d) authorizes the assessment of a special service charge if the nature or volume of public records is such as to require extensive use of information technology resources or extensive clerical or supervisory assistance.

The nature and volume of the records your amended request seeks will require extensive clerical or supervisory assistance. As such, prior to furnishing any of the judicial records that you have requested, we will need to receive an advance deposit of the special services charge.

In calculating an estimate of the special services charge to fulfill the amended request regarding Judge Ayers' records, 432 emails have been identified that may be responsive to your amended public records request. The total estimated special services charge of \$236.02, as documented below, does not include shipping charges or the 15-cent per page duplication

Mr. Christopher Hanson
December 17, 2025
Page 2

cost. We cannot estimate the shipping and duplication charges until we determine how many non-confidential records are responsive to your request.

FUNCTION	TIME	RATE	COST
Paralegal to review 432 emails for confidential information and, if applicable, redact confidential information from those records	Estimated time: 3.6 hours (30 seconds per e-mail = $432 \times 30 = 12,960$ seconds $\div 60$ seconds = 216 minutes $\div 60$ minutes = 3.6 hours)	\$40.04 per hour (\$29.66 base pay plus 35% benefits)	\$144.14
Staff counsel to review paralegal's work	Estimated time = 1.0 hour	\$91.88 per hour (\$68.06 base pay plus 35% benefits)	\$91.88
TOTAL ESTIMATED SPECIAL SERVICES CHARGE			\$236.02

Please be advised that in order to begin the work of reviewing the identified records for confidential information, we must first receive a deposit of \$236.02. You may submit a check for this amount made payable to "BOCC" to my assistant: Janice Albury, Thirteenth Judicial Circuit, George Edgecomb Courthouse, 800 East Twiggs Street, Room 604, Tampa FL 33602.

After the records are reviewed and confidential information is redacted from these records, a final invoice will be prepared and provided to you indicating the special services charge actually incurred, the shipping charges, and the duplication costs. If the amount due on the final invoice is more than your deposit, then you will be required to pay the difference prior to delivery of the records. If the amount due on the final invoice is less than your deposit, we will start a refund process when we send you the non-confidential records.

Sincerely, .



Richard T. Melendi
Chief Deputy Court Administrator - Operations

cc: K. Angela Smith, Interim Court Administrator

Re: Additional Public Records Requests, Follow up for Compliance on Previous requests, and the Court's bad faith in attempting to avoid Constitutional Duties

From: cahanson77@yahoo.com (cahanson77@yahoo.com)

To: publicinfo@fljud13.org; tca@fljud13.org; melendrt@fljud13.org; truthoverchaos@outlook.com

Date: Friday, December 19, 2025 at 10:22 AM EST

Good morning. I received your recent correspondence detailing quotes for public records access, just to determine cost of reproduction.... that already totals something approaching \$2,000.

Before I consider paying so much money for these records, I need to know that the 13th Circuit is not going to engage in the type of the still unexplained activity described below - document dumping unrequested records in an attempt to hide the intentional concealment. As explained again below - "The issue, as I've repeatedly explained, is that your office engaged in classic "document dumping" with a side of "intentional concealment"—a form of discovery abuse where a party floods the requester with voluminous, irrelevant materials (in this case, communications from unrequested hearings) to bury or conceal the specifically targeted records."

This is exactly what I believe the 13th Circuit did in relation to materials on the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearing materials addressed below. It demonstrates a willingness to violate any semblance of ethical duties when the objective is protecting insiders like Ayers.

This needs a response. What is the 13th Circuit's position on this. It was a narrow issue when I requested these materials months ago. The Court's attempt to hide its deceit and concealment did not work. Please respond with the Court's position today. It has gone on far too long, in bad faith.

Thank you for your cooperation and I look forward to hearing from you.

Chris

On Thursday, December 4, 2025 at 05:07:18 PM EST, cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com> wrote:

Good afternoon, Mr. Melendi,

Thank you for your response, but it is blatantly disingenuous and further exemplifies the 13th Circuit's pattern of obstruction and bad-faith tactics in handling public records requests. You reference the August 21, 2025, mailed response and the records I picked up on August 26, 2025—as if I were unaware of them. Of course I know; I immediately scanned those 377 pages (including duplicates) and emailed them back to your office to create a verifiable record of what was produced. The issue, as I've repeatedly explained, is that your office engaged in classic "document dumping" with a side of "intentional concealment"—a form of discovery abuse where a party floods the requester with voluminous, irrelevant materials (in this case, communications from unrequested hearings) to bury or conceal the specifically targeted records.

At this point, it's blatantly obvious it's not an honest mistake; it's sanctionable bad-faith conduct under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420 and the Florida Constitution. It's insider protectionism no matter the judicial misconduct or the damage that it causes. It's reprehensible conduct for 13th Circuit professionals to act this manner - intentionally hindering access and eroding constitutional rights. It certainly qualifies as willful misconduct that exposes individuals to personal liability under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 for what's far beyond deliberate indifference to due process and public access rights under the First and Fourteenth Amendments.

I've sent you the chain containing the timely and persistent follow up on the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 records multiple times.

This is from the attached email I sent back on 8-31-25 enclosing the paper copies provided:

"I picked up paper copies of the records after paying the requested fees at the courthouse the day I first received the letter. However, I've encountered issues that require further action: incomplete/unreadable records, missing communications, and a lack of documentation regarding devices searched. The provided documents lack critical communications, such as documents involving the authority to schedule the December 13, 2024, hearing on such an emergent basis, over a pro se litigant's objections. Of particular concern is the after-hours decisions on December 12, 2024. No records show Judge Ayers directing or being informed of the scheduling, despite my objection to the date due to unavailability (emails to Heyward, December 11 and 12, 2024). This contrasts with the Court's handling of other emergency motions, such as my December 30, 2024, motion, which received judicial review. No communications indicate Judge Ayers was aware of Scott Davis's intent not to attend the January 9, 2025, hearing, despite his email to Heyward on January 8, 2025, stating his intent not to attend, which elicited an immediate objection from myself. It's concerning that these documents were not produced in the initial response. Please ensure a search for all text messages and after-hours communications related to the hearings on December 13, 2024 and

January 9, 2025, as they are critical to the records request. Also, no records confirm that my objections to the December 13, 2024, hearing or Davis's non-attendance at the January 9, 2025, hearing were forwarded to Judge Ayers. Please verify whether these communications were shared with her, as their absence suggests a procedural oversight critical to my appeal (Case No. 2D2025-1936).]The absence of any documented correspondence between Judge Ayers and Dwauna Heyward regarding the scheduling of the December 13, 2024, hearing, my objection to it due to unavailability (emails to Heyward, December 11 and 12, 2024), and my objection to Scott Davis's non-attendance at the January 9, 2025, hearing (emails to Heyward and Davis, January 8-9, 2025) is highly irregular, especially given Ayers's documented involvement in other case management matters. There is a concern over a lack of judicial oversight that prejudiced my due process rights as a pro se litigant."

I scanned those in and provided them back to you contemporaneously in anticipation of something like this. I am surprised that a judicial organization like the 13th Circuit can be this corrupt although you all certainly confirm it again and again. The Administrator's misconduct with the "document dumping" further illustrates the intentional concealment with respect to the hearings that involve serious attorney and judicial misconduct. It also confirms that you consider such correspondence "public records" The amount of emails for the unrequested hearings confirm for me that you all are hiding some really interesting stuff. It still doesn't give you the right to conceal it.

What has the 13th Circuit done to comply with its constitutional obligations in response to my 8-31 email quoted above and the various follow ups also in the chain??

All you're doing is delaying the inevitable and ruining another Christmas for this family. I hope someone there still has some integrity and becomes a whistleblower on the truly disgusting levels of corruption that have infected your organization.

The 13th Circuit is not above the constitution and certainly not above the truth. If you are telling me that for the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearings, there is no correspondence responsive to the requests, provide an affidavit confirming a thorough search (including personal devices and accounts) by close of business tomorrow. Otherwise, produce them immediately, without further excuses or fees. What do you hope to accomplish by continuing to dodge these simple issues? I look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,
Christopher A. Hanson, Esq.
Florida Bar No. 44094

727-409-5738

cahanson77@yahoo.com

On Thursday, December 4, 2025 at 03:09:20 PM EST, Melendi, Rick <melendr@fljud13.org> wrote:

Good afternoon Mr. Hanson,

This email serves as a follow-up response to your email of December 3, 2025 at 4:38 p.m.

As it relates to your request for materials related to the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings, a public records response addressing the records from those dates was mailed to you on August 21, 2025. In fact, a revised records response dated August 26, 2025, along with the records satisfying the request were produced and picked up by you at the Courts Business Center on August 26, 2025.

Sincerely,

Rick Melendi

From: cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com>

Sent: Wednesday, December 3, 2025 4:38 PM

To: Info, Public <publicinfo@fljud13.org>; recordsrequests@fljud13.org; TCA <TCA@fljud13.org>; Melendi, Rick <MELENDRT@fljud13.org>

Subject: Re: Additional Public Records Requests, Follow up for Compliance on Previous requests, and the Court's bad faith in attempting to avoid Constitutional Duties

Caution: This is an external email. Please take care when clicking links or opening attachments. When in doubt, contact the Helpdesk.

Good afternoon. That is completely unacceptable as to the longstanding requests for materials related to the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearings that the Administrator's office purposefully concealed, while providing the equivalent of what was requested, but only for all of the hearings, not requested, and thus not relevant. If you're trying to restart the clock on that, it's patently absurd and just another transparent attempt at delay, obstruction and concealment, further demonstrating the need for searches of all relevant personal devices about coordination and insider protectionism.

If the "amended public records request" is referring only to the 2 narrowed requests specifically relating to your recent cost estimates on Ayers and Felix materials, I could understand that.

Please clarify your position and explain why I still do not have those materials on the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearings so I may continue to take appropriate action.

Thank you for your cooperation.

On Wednesday, December 3, 2025 at 03:47:48 PM EST, Melendi, Rick <melendrt@fljud13.org> wrote:

Good afternoon Mr. Hanson,

In accordance with your email request of December 2, 2025, please be advised that we are treating your requests as an Amended Public Records Request. A search of the records consistent with the outlined terms of your amended requests, specifically contained in the - **Narrowed scope of Public Records Requests for Ayers and Felix materials and Request for Immediate compliance** section of your email, will be

conducted and a response will be provided in accordance with Rule 2.420(m) of the Florida Rules of General Practice and Judicial Administration.

Thank you for your attention in this matter.

Sincerely,

Rick Melendi

From: cahanson77@yahoo.com <cahanson77@yahoo.com>

Sent: Tuesday, December 2, 2025 6:15 AM

To: Melendi, Rick <MELENDRT@fljud13.org>; Info, Public <publicinfo@fljud13.org>;
recordsrequests@fljud13.org; TCA <TCA@fljud13.org>

Subject: Additional Public Records Requests, Follow up for Compliance on Previous requests, and the Court's bad faith in attempting to avoid Constitutional Duties

Caution: This is an external email. Please take care when clicking links or opening attachments. When in doubt, contact the Helpdesk.

Good afternoon Mr. Melendi. I received 2 letters from you via mail since our conversation and email below. It only took you about 2 minutes to send the email below. I requested during our conversation and many other times throughout my efforts to obtain constitutional transparency, that you send such correspondence by email. Is there a reason why you're continuing to use mail and only obliged with the request for emailing documents on the one occasion reflected below?

I am writing primarily in response to your recent letters dated November 25, 2025, and November 26, 2025, regarding my public records requests for materials related to Judges Ayers and Felix. Before addressing the excessive fee demands outlined in those letters, I must first highlight my concerns over whether the 13th Circuit will ever simply provide relevant and consequential materials in its possession given the clear pattern of obstruction in your office's handling of my requests. While a relatively minor one, the refusal to simply email documents seems to be an effort to, at a minimum, slow down my efforts to obtain transparency. I think forcing me to pick up printed copies was part of that attempt to blur the lines of what was actually produced. I foresaw that concern and immediately scanned everything provided to me and sent it back to the 13th Circuit electronically, thus creating a record of precisely what was produced.

There is a very serious and sneaky violation of the Judicial code of conduct when one looks at my initial records requests and the Court's voluminous responsive documents. The Court, thru its administrator at the time, engaged in bad faith litigation/discovery tactics usually employed only by the most unscrupulous of lawyers:

- **"Selective Disclosure as Obstruction: Overburdening with Unrequested Records to Evade Relevant Production"**
- **"Concealment Through Volume: Provision of Irrelevant Materials as a Tactic to Hinder Access to Targeted Records"**

Given that the Court has unrefutably engaged in these tactics, and still has not produced the relevant communications requested all the way back in July demonstrates a willingness to conceal evidence of insider misconduct at all costs. I'll proceed with the state court litigation and proceed to Federal Courts to expose this as soon as time permits. However, I understand you were not involved in the production of those records. I hope that you and/or Ms. K. Angela Smith, interim Court Administrator will see how blatant and severe the cover up attempts have been and begin to offer real transparency consistent with your constitutional duties. I intend to pursue all available civil claims against all those involved in such egregious misconduct that has already impacted me and my family significantly.

Intentionally Deceitful, Obstructive and Bad Faith Production: Flooding with Irrelevant Records to Conceal and Deny Access to Requested Materials

As detailed in my initial public records requests (see the attached Composite of First 5 Public Records Requests.pdf, particularly the requests dated July 24, 2025, and subsequent follow-ups), I specifically sought all emails, text messages, and other communications related to the scheduling or attendance at the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, hearings in Case No. 24-DR-001150. These requests were narrow, targeted, and directly tied to allegations of procedural irregularities and potential misconduct in my case—issues that are central to my ongoing appeal and my amended petition for writ of mandamus (Case No. 25-CA-10255).

In response to these narrow, targeted requests, your office has provided correspondence related to other hearings (which I did not request), while completely withholding or ignoring the materials for the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, hearings. This selective production does not fulfill my requests and raises obvious concerns about intentional concealment.

Under Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420, you have a duty to produce all responsive records without unreasonable delay or artificial barriers. Providing irrelevant materials while evading the core requests constitutes an extremely concerning constructive denial and further evidence of bad faith, especially given the public interest in transparency regarding judicial bias and systemic corruption. The 13th Circuit's reactions to my attempts to ensure constitutional transparency are antithetical to the Court's most basic function providing further evidence of wrongdoing and raising even greater concerns about what the Court system is hiding on behalf of Ayers and others.

The 13th Circuit's apparent bad faith and intentional avoidance of constitutional transparency include violations of various Rules on Judicial conduct:

- Canon 2A of the Florida Code of Judicial Conduct (requiring judges and staff to avoid impropriety and the appearance of impropriety, which is violated by tactics that suggest manipulation to protect insiders and erode public trust in the judiciary).
- Canon 3B(2) of the Florida Code of Judicial Conduct (requiring judges to ensure court officials and staff act ethically, breached by failing to oversee

administrators who engage in obstructive responses).

- Canon 3B(7) of the Florida Code of Judicial Conduct (requiring judges to accord every person the right to be heard according to law, violated by obstructing access to relevant records, thereby denying due process in ongoing litigation).
- Florida Rule of Judicial Administration 2.420 (mandating custodians provide access without unreasonable delay or barriers, breached by selective or obstructive production that creates artificial hurdles to transparency)

Request for bare minimum compliance with my initial public Records requests from July 2025 seeking correspondence and materials related to the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearings clearly and sneakily concealed ever since.

I request immediate production of the withheld correspondence for the specified hearings, including any communications on personal devices. If these records do not exist, please provide an affidavit confirming a thorough search, including the devices and accounts searched. Failure to comply promptly will be added as additional grounds in the public records litigation strengthening my claim for attorney's fees and costs, and potential damages against individuals who violated their duties with actual malice under 42 U.S.C. § 1983 (authorizing personal liability against state actors for intentional or deliberate indifference to violations of federal constitutional rights, such as due process under the 14th Amendment, where qualified immunity may be overcome if the conduct was objectively unreasonable and the right was clearly established) and Florida Statute § 768.28(9)(a) (waiving sovereign immunity and allowing personal tort liability for state employees or agents who act in bad faith, with malicious purpose, or in a manner exhibiting wanton and willful disregard of human rights, safety, or property, which aligns with an "actual malice" or willful misconduct standard in obstructing public records access tied to constitutional protections. I would hope that someone within the 13th Circuit, perhaps the interim administrator, will see that supporting a corrupt judge and system to the detriment of citizens is wrong. All I'm asking of you and the Ms. Smith is to follow your constitutional mandates and seek whistleblower protection if necessary.

Regardless, there is no basis for the sneaky manner in which the Court burdened me with voluminous records, not requested, while withholding the equivalent for the

hearings requested.

Please immediately provide me with all correspondence and materials relating to the 12-13-24 and 1-9-25 hearings. Or provide some justification for the Court's handling of it to date. Failure to accomplish that this week is a willful violation of 42 U.S.C. § 1983 and will require Civil Litigation for damages on that basis alone if not rectified.

Unreasonable fee demands designed to deter my efforts to obtain records under the constitution to protect insider misconduct: Request for itemized breakdown,

Regarding the fee demands—nearly \$8,000 for Judge Ayers' disqualification materials and \$350 for Judge Felix's records—these appear grossly inflated, unjustified, and demanded as part of a larger pattern to continue to conceal further evidence of Judge Ayers' misconduct. I believe any continuing attempts to support or protect Ayers' at the expense of me and my family are intentionally malicious and unlawful. Special service charges are limited to actual costs for "extensive" requests, based solely on the lowest-paid employee's salary and benefits for time directly spent. *Please provide an immediate itemized breakdown, including:*

- *Specific tasks performed or anticipated.*
- *Hours estimated, with hourly rates.*
- *Justification for classifying these requests as "extensive."*
- *Any consideration of a fee waiver or reduction due to the overwhelming public interest in exposing potential judicial misconduct and systemic corruption in the 13th Circuit, as detailed in my petition* (see AGO 2000-11).

These fees seem designed to deter access, which violates Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution. To mitigate costs, I request the option to inspect the records in person on-site at your office, without any copying charges, as permitted under § 119.07(1)(a), F.S., which allows free inspection under supervision. Please advise on available times for such an inspection and confirm that no fees will apply for review alone.

Narrowed scope of Public Records Requests for Ayers and Felix materials and Request for immediate compliance.

Additionally, to further narrow the scope and reduce potential costs, for the Judge Felix records, please limit the search to communications, emails, pleadings, or correspondence specifically related to venue transfer or change of venue in Case

No. 24-DR-001150, including any from or referencing Chris Hanson (or Christopher Hanson), as well as keywords such as "Ayers," "venue change," "transfer venue," "bias," "recusal," "misconduct," "bias," "Hanson v. Hanson," "due process violation," "disqualification," "conflict of interest," or "appeal transfer." This refinement should make the request less burdensome while focusing on the most relevant materials. For the Judge Ayers requests, please produce only the requested records for all cases that involve the law firm, Ayo and Iken. Again, time is of the essence. You've already identified thousands of emails. Please narrow that to include only cases involving Ayo and Iken and let me know when I can review those materials avoiding additional costs meant to deter my efforts to obtain constitutional transparency.

Further Inquiries Regarding the Court's Ongoing Concealment of Video of the April 4, 2025 Hearing Offered by Judge Ayers on the Record in Open Court

Regarding the April 4, 2025 hearing video, which Judge Ayers explicitly referenced and offered to obtain during the proceedings (as reflected on page 75 of the hearing transcript), I inquire whether the 13th Circuit has conducted a formal balancing test under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and cases like Barron v. Florida Freedom Newspapers, Inc., 531 So. 2d 113 (Fla. 1988), weighing the overwhelming public interest in transparency—particularly in exposing judicial bias and misconduct—against any claimed security exemption under Fla. R. Jud. Admin. 2.420(c)(8) and Fla. Stat. § 119.071(3)(a).

Judge Ayers' on-the-record statement introducing the video's relevance and her intent to provide it post-hearing appears to waive or undermine any blanket exemption, yet your office continues to classify it as non-disclosable "surveillance footage" without explanation, contributing to unreasonable delays in violation of § 119.07(1), F.S., especially as I have been awaiting responsive materials since July 2025.

Has anyone at the 13th Circuit, including Chief Judge Sabella or relevant staff, even viewed the video to assess its contents or confirm its classification? Please clarify the distinction between "security cameras" (as claimed) and cameras specifically designed or positioned to capture courtroom hearings, including whether this video was recorded via a dedicated judicial recording system rather than general surveillance. To facilitate review and ensure compliance, please provide a privilege log or detailed description identifying the camera(s), system, and technical specifications used for the recording, along with any metadata or logs showing

access or review history, within 5 business days to avoid further escalation in my mandamus petition. This serves as an additional and separate Public Records request for the these materials.

Conclusion:

I hope that under the interim Court Administrator, Ms. Smith, I will begin to find some compliance. I do not seem to have her email address, but please forward this to her with a copy to me. Given the 13th Circuit's demonstrated bad faith in handling prior requests—flooding me with unrequested materials while concealing the very communications I sought for the December 13, 2024, and January 9, 2025, hearings—it is absurd and further indicative of obstruction to now demand over \$8,000 for additional records. This pattern of evasion, in direct violation of constitutional duties under Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution and § 119.07, F.S., undermines any claim to good faith and bolsters my arguments for fee waivers, expedited production, and personal liability for those involved

As I noted in my November 13, 2025, email (attached for reference), I remain open to clarifying any aspects of my requests to facilitate compliance. However, the pattern of delays, selective responses, and prohibitive fees must end. Please respond substantively this week or I will proceed with further escalating the litigation to eventually involve claims for personal liability for willful and malicious violations of public duties. I understand how badly the Court wants this to go away. It will not happen until there are consequences for all involved in this intentional corruption involving so many different actors all willing to harm my family to protect insiders. This goes against the most basic duty you all have as Court officials and eventually, it will be addressed with the seriousness it requires.

Thank you for your immediate attention. Sincerely,

Christopher A. Hanson

3934 E Eden Roc Cir

Tampa, FL 33634

727-409-5738

cahanson77@yahoo.com

Attachments:

- [Recent responses to records requests demanding over \\$8,000 for transparency](#)
- [Composite of first 5 public records requests.pdf](#)
- [11-13 follow up on records email to Melendi.pdf](#)
- [10-9-25 EMAIL chain to Moore.pdf](#)

On Thursday, November 20, 2025 at 05:32:38 PM EST, Melendi, Rick <melendr@fljud13.org> wrote:

Good evening Mr. Hanson,

As you requested during our conversation today at 4:50 p.m., attached is a copy of the letter I mailed to you on November 19, 2025.

Sincerely,

Rick Melendi



Rick Melendi
Chief Deputy
Court
Operations
800 E. Twiggs
St.
Edgecomb
6040
Tampa, FL
33602
P: (813) 272-
5371
www.fljud13.org

IN THE CIRCUIT COURT OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT
IN AND FOR HILLSBOROUGH COUNTY, FLORIDA
CIVIL DIVISION

CHRISTOPHER HANSON,
Plaintiff/Petitioner,

vs.

CASE NO.: 25-CA-10255
DIVISION: "B"

THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT COURT
CLERK OF THE THIRTEENTH JUDICIAL CIRCUIT,
CHIEF JUDGE CHRISTOPHER C.
SABELLA, JUDGE KELLY AYERS, GINA
JUSTICE (or current court administrator), MIKE
MOORE,
Defendants/Respondents.

_____ /

Verified motion to disqualify all 13th Judicial Circuit Judges and for reassignment to a neutral circuit Pursuant to § 38.10, Fla. Stat.; Fla. R. Gen. Prac. & Jud. Admin. 2.160; and Canon 3E(1)

Introduction and procedural posture

1. This is an original circuit court action under Chapter 119, Florida Statutes, and Article I, Section 24 of the Florida Constitution, seeking a writ of mandamus to compel production of unlawfully withheld public records, declaratory relief, and attorney's fees and costs, directly impacting Plaintiff and his minor children in Case No. 24-DR-001150.
2. The withheld records concern a yearlong pattern of severe misconduct and systemic corruption. Plaintiff seeks documentation including that related to judicial communications, scheduling, recusal, hearing videos, and related materials likely to produce further evidence of and explanation for the bias, corruption, and misconduct within the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit throughout the proceedings in Case No. 24-DR-001150.

3. On October 15, 2025, this Court entered an order transferring this case to the Second District Court of Appeal. On October 16, 2025, the Court vacated that transfer order. The Court has indicated it believes it lacks jurisdiction to consider any claim against another judge in this circuit but will retain the case because nonjudicial respondents are named.
4. The barrier presented here is not subject-matter jurisdiction; it is an institutional conflict of interest. The proper remedy is disqualification of all Thirteenth Judicial Circuit judges and reassignment to a neutral circuit.

Legal basis for disqualification and reassignment

5. Section 38.10, Florida Statutes, requires disqualification where a party fears they will not receive a fair trial due to bias or interest. Rule 2.160(f) mandates that a legally sufficient motion be granted immediately, with no further action taken by the disqualified judge. Canon 3E(1) requires disqualification where impartiality might reasonably be questioned.
6. A circuit-wide institutional conflict arises where the court itself is a named defendant, sitting judges (including the Chief Judge) are parties, and the litigation challenges the administrative integrity and conduct of circuit personnel. In such circumstances, reassignment outside the circuit is functionally mandatory to preserve due process and public confidence.
7. There is an institutional due process problem with respect to the 13th Circuit's handling of any litigation involving the undersigned either as a party or as an attorney.
8. Pursuant to Walls v. State, 910 So. 2d 432 (Fla. 4th DCA 2005), and Mulligan v. Mulligan, 877 So. 2d 791 (Fla. 4th DCA 2004), disqualification of a judge in one matter due to bias, conflict, or the appearance of impropriety extends broadly to related or

interconnected proceedings involving the same parties, attorneys, or institutional interests, ensuring the preservation of due process and public confidence in the judiciary.

9. In Walls, the Fourth District Court of Appeal granted a writ of prohibition disqualifying a trial judge in a criminal case where the judge had previously recused herself in an unrelated pending matter involving the same defendant, holding that such prior recusal created legally sufficient grounds for disqualification to avoid any reasonable fear of partiality.
10. Similarly, in Mulligan, the court mandated disqualification across all cases involving a specific attorney after the judge recused in one instance due to a personal conflict with that attorney, emphasizing that recusal in a single case necessitates removal from any related or ongoing matters to prevent systemic bias.
11. Here, the institutional entanglement and conflicts inherent in this public records action—where the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit itself, its Chief Judge, and other judges are named defendants accused of misconduct, bias, and concealment directly tied to the underlying family law proceedings in Case No. 24-DR-001150, create an irreconcilable appearance of impropriety for all judges within the circuit. This requires disqualification not only in this case but also in the related family law matter to uphold the integrity of the judicial process.

Factual background

12. Between July 24, 2025 and September 4, 2025, Plaintiff submitted multiple public records requests to the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit and the Clerk, seeking judicial disqualification and recusal records, administrative communications concerning the GAL issue, transcripts referenced in public proceedings, emails and texts of Judges Kelly Ayers

and Wendy DePaul and their judicial assistants related to scheduling and objections, and visual and audio recordings of specified hearings.

13. Despite statutory deadlines and persistent follow-up, Defendants failed to produce requested records, provide lawful justifications, or respond to specific inquiries. Partial responses from Court Administrator Gina Justice on August 21, September 4, and September 8, 2025 acknowledged the existence of responsive records but asserted exemptions and demanded payment without full production. The Court uniformly failed to respond as to what devices were searched as part of the response process.

Communications related to the hearings and issues with extreme bias concerns were conspicuously absent from the responses.

14. The September 8, 2025 response specifically denied access to the April 4, 2025 hearing video based on confidentiality claims, despite Judge Ayers referencing and offering the video on the record, raising concerns of inconsistent treatment and concealment efforts once her threat to produce the video did not produce the result she hoped.

15. Plaintiff exhausted informal remedies and administrative channels with follow-ups on August 26, August 31, September 9, September 12, September 24, and October 9, 2025. There were no substantive responses following September 9, 2025 beyond an acknowledgment from Mike Moore, constituting constructive denial and evidence of bad faith.

16. Specific failures include: no affidavits describing search methods or devices (including personal devices); no explanation for the lack of communications regarding the December 13, 2024 and January 9, 2025 hearings; no clarification as to the existence of “security” video only for April 4, 2025 (Docket #198), whether the camera is part of a

security system, and why no similar footage exists for other hearings; refusal to provide information by email and reliance on U.S. Mail to delay access; and no written explanations with specific statutory citations for any withholdings.

17. Defendants' non-response to targeted inquiries, coupled with partial responses and the absurd bias and results in the related family law case, reveal bias and a "clubhouse" rules protection pattern among circuit insiders, violating Florida public records law. This obstruction has caused ongoing harm to Plaintiff and his family, including escalating damage to the children and Plaintiff's health.
18. The pattern of delays, non-responses, and incomplete disclosures appears designed to protect Judge Ayers and avoid production of evidence that could result in embarrassment or discipline. The underlying family case hinges on Husband's financial discovery efforts in the face of Wife's concealment of marital assets; court actions have assisted obstruction and suppressed evidence of ethical misconduct by multiple attorneys.
19. Exhibits attached to the Petition and prior filings include: composite requests; Gina Justice's letters; the September 8, 2025 video denial; April 4, 2025 transcript excerpts documenting the court's acknowledgment of video; the October 9, 2025 email chain to Mike Moore; and correspondence to Chief Judge Sabella detailing non-responses.
(Docket #6).

Clarification regarding prior transfer order and Escambia County

20. The vacated transfer order cited § 26.012, *Dept. of Com'ty Affrs. v. Escambia Cnty.*, 582 So. 2d 1237, 1239 (Fla. 1st DCA 1991). *Escambia* involved a jurisdictional framework where circuit court review of certain quasi-judicial actions was barred; it did not involve the circuit itself as a party nor an institutional conflict necessitating disqualification. Here,

other circuits have jurisdiction to hear a mandamus action compelling ministerial public records duties; the impediment is local judicial conflict, not a statewide jurisdictional bar.

Verified declaration

21. I, Christopher Hanson, declare under penalty of perjury that the statements made herein and those from the Verified Petition and corresponding Exhibit Composite (Docket #3, 6), all incorporated here by reference, are true and correct to the best of my knowledge.

Relief requested

22. Disqualify all judges of the Thirteenth Judicial Circuit from presiding over this case and the related case, Case No. 24-DR-001150, based on *Walls* and *Mulligan*.

23. Request administrative reassignment by this Court, the 13th Circuit's Chief Judge, and/or the Chief Justice of the Florida Supreme Court to a neutral judge in another circuit (e.g., the Tenth Judicial Circuit, Polk County).

24. Maintain the case in circuit court jurisdiction, consistent with Article V, § 5(b), Florida Constitution, and § 26.012, Florida Statutes, and proceed under Rule 2.160(f) with immediate disqualification and no further action by any conflicted judge.

25. Award attorney's fees and costs under § 119.12, Florida Statutes, and grant such other relief as is just and proper.

Certified and executed on October 31, 2025,

/s/ Christopher Hanson
 Christopher Hanson, Esq.
 Florida Bar No. 44094
 cahanson77@yahoo.com |
 727-409-5738

Certificate of Service

I HEREBY CERTIFY that a true and correct copy of the foregoing Verified Motion to Disqualify All 13th Judicial Circuit Judges and for Reassignment to a Neutral Circuit, along with all accompanying exhibits (if any), was filed through the Florida Courts E-Filing Portal and service attempted via the Portal's e-service system on October 31, 2025, (with additional email service directly from Plaintiff) to the following recipients: Clerk of Court for the 13th Judicial Circuit at info@hillsclerk.com 13th Judicial Circuit Court at rowlanda@fljud13.org, TCA@fljud13.org, as Court Administrator per email from Gina Justice who left her employment at the 13th Circuit, Mike Moore, Public Information Officer, mike.moore@fljud13.org Judge Kelly Ayers at famlawdivd@fljud.org Judge Christopher Sabella at cornelcm@fljud13.org.

/s/ Christopher Hanson

Christopher Hanson, Esq.

Florida Bar No. 44094

cahanson77@yahoo.com (<mailto:cahanson77@yahoo.com>)

727-409-5738